

ANOTHER LONELY NIGHT

Written by

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FADE IN:

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

It's around nine o'clock, the street is almost empty. There is a woman waiting for the bus at the stop. A couple of guys stand at the corner smoking something, piles of smoke blow from their mouths as they breath through the cold evening.

The hall of the building in the middle of the street lights up. A black car passes in front of it and picks up the woman from the nearby bus stop.

A young man walks down the stairs in the building. He is LEWIS, 25. He's a journalist for the local paper which has its offices upstairs, he looks tired, very tired.

Lewis exits from the glass doors, then suddenly stops, as if struck by a lightning thought. He brings his eyes back to the hall, the lights switch off, he shrugs then looks around for a moment. It seems like he's looking for something or someone.

He stands there a little longer while loosening his tie. He looks down, he's beat. Right in that moment an HOMELESS MAN with a large white beard bumps into him seemingly out of nowhere. The man's holding an half-empty bottle of beer in his right hand.

HOMELESS MAN
FUCK YOU MAN!

The man proceeds to stagger away.

LEWIS
(RE: the beer bottle)
Hey! Be careful with that.

Without even turning around the homeless man bends over and smashes the bottle on the curb. He slowly turns his attention to Lewis, he looks at him right in the eyes without a single drop of respect, then points the broken bottle at him as if it were a sword.

HOMELESS MAN
You better shut your fucking mouth
if you want to keep it.

The homeless man moves like he's about to throw the glass at Lewis whom instinctively flinches.

The homeless man scoffs and lets the bottle fall before going about his business.

EXT. BUS STOP - MOMENTS LATER

Lewis sits on the bench. He checks his phone, it's 9.14. He starts scrolling down mindlessly.

A VOICE ON HIS RIGHT
You all right man?

Standing on his side it's WALKER a tall, slick guy dressed in a large purple hoodie and grey sweat pants.

LEWIS
(surprised)
What?

WALKER
Are you okay?

Lewis is startled, he's not used to this kind of interaction.

LEWIS
Uhm... yeah, thanks.

Lewis tightens his tie and scoops a little to his left.

WALKER
I ain't tryna rob you man...chill out.

Lewis now feels embarrassed.

WALKER (CONT'D)
You just seem... I don't know... kinda lost.

LEWIS
(getting worried)
No actually... I'm fine.

WALKER
You absolutely sure *Lewis*?

Lewis rapidly turns, he's visibly shocked.

LEWIS
How do you...

WALKER
(pointing at Lewis' back)
Right there, on your jacket's tag.
"PROPRIETY OF LEWIS GIBSON"... A little corny if you ask me.

Lewis smiles softly, tension relieving from his shoulders.

WALKER (CONT'D)
Listen... it's okay man... I ain't
tryna bother you.

LEWIS
(a little cold)
Thank you.

WALKER
It's Walker by the way.

LEWIS
Lewis. Lewis Gibson.

WALKER
Yeah. I know.

Lewis goes back to the mindless scrolling, Walker starts smoking a cigarette but as he's putting the lighter back in his pocket, his bus, the 36, approaches from the distance.

WALKER
Every damn time.

Lewis isn't really paying attention so he just nods in agreement.

LEWIS
Yeah...

Walker notices but doesn't really care.

The 36 finally arrives and stops by the sidewalk, Walker throws the cigarette to the ground and steps on it. Lewis stands up and goes for the bus but stops when notices the number painted on the side. Walker hops on.

LEWIS
Shouldn't it be the 71?

WALKER
Not tonight.

LEWIS
Why not?

WALKER
(as the doors close)
I don't know. You tell me.

Walker winks at Lewis, then the 71 takes off.

Lewis is left there alone in astonishment.

It should have been the 71, shouldn't it? He's not so sure anymore. He decides to check the schedule board behind him.

LEWIS
71... Wednesday ... 9.17... right
here.

What he fails to notice is that the board doesn't say anything about a number 36.

The guys that were on the corner before walk past him on the other side of the road. Lewis is not convinced, he's not good with this things, but he doesn't have any other choice.

LEWIS
(shouting)
Hey! Hey guys!

The guys stop immediately, Lewis gets intimidated by the way they did.

LEWIS (CONT'D)
(after clearing his
voice)
Do you know wether the 36 is coming
tonight?

GUY #1
I don't know. We're not from around
here.

LEWIS
You are not?

GUY #2
Yeah. We from somewhere else.

LEWIS
But...
(considering)
...nothing. Have a nice evening.

The two guys scan Lewis from head to toe, they look briefly at each other and without saying a word agree to cross roads.

They come very close to Lewis.

GUY #1
Is there a problem?

LEWIS
(once again, scared)
No... everything's cool.

GUY #2
You seem scared.

LEWIS
Well... you guys kind of pulled up
on me.

GUY #1
That's 'cause you made it seem like
there was some kind of problem.

LEWIS
There isn't.

GUY #2
There better not be.

LEWIS
I assure you. There isn't.

One of the guys dully pushes Lewis's shoulder almost making
him fall. They laugh and walk away.

Lewis stands still, he's petrified. He waits for them to be
a little further away and adjusts his jacket.

GUY #1
(shouting from a
distance)
YOUR BUS AIN'T COMING MAN!

LEWIS
(sure they can't hear
him)
The fuck?

GUY #1
(same as before)
YOU KNOW WHAT I SAID!

Lewis is starting to think there's something wrong with this
night but soon snaps out of it appealing to some good old-
fashioned pragmatism.

He takes out his phone and calls a friend. It rings.

Rings some more. And some more. Then again.

Lewis checks to see if he's called the right number, it says
"PETAH", so yeah, it's the right number.

Lewis is almost ready to let it go when...

PETER (O.S.)
Hey Lew, what's up?

LEWIS
Hey man, am I interrupting or something?

PETER (O.S.)
Nah man, just playing some COD why?

LEWIS
Listen... I need a ride.

PETER (O.S.)
(surprised)
From where?

LEWIS
From work Pete.

PETER (O.S.)
Can't you catch the bus?

LEWIS
The 71 ain't coming tonight.

PETER (O.S.)
Right.

LEWIS
What? Is that common knowledge?

PETER (O.S.)
What'd you mean?

LEWIS
Nothing, listen, can you come pick me up or not?

PETER (O.S.)
No can do Lew, Melissa is getting a full check-up this week.

LEWIS
You should really stop calling your car Melissa, it's creepy.

PETER (O.S.)
You're just a hater 'cause you got no whip.

LEWIS
Whatever man... can't you just take
Gina's car?

PETER (O.S.)
Gina ain't here.

LEWIS
Why not?

PETER (O.S.)
She works nights on Wednesdays.

LEWIS
Right...
(a beat)
Just...please don't make me take a
cab after nine, you know how it is.

PETER (O.S.)
Sorry Lew... wish I could help.

LEWIS
Yeah right...

PETER (O.S.)
(inattentive)
Oh man... before I forget... I
don't think you're gonna see many
cabs tonight.

LEWIS
'scuse me? Why not?

Lewis hears some war-like noises over the phone.

LEWIS (CONT'D)
Pete? You there?

PETER (O.S.)
Sorry man, gotta go. See you
tomorrow.

Peter hangs up. Lewis lets himself go and falls down on the
bench where he was sitting before.

How the fuck is he going to get home?

EXT. ANOTHER, LARGER STREET - LATER

By cab, of course. What was Peter even talking about? What
does he know?

Lewis' now walking down a street which is a little more crowded, in fact, he walks past a bar which is surprisingly lively for a Wednesday night.

There's a group of college students being weirdly quiet standing next to the fake-wooden bar door, they seem to be concerned about a friend of theirs which is a little afar talking to a guy. The aspect of the guy is what is worrying to them: he's wearing a dark blue tailored Valentino suit with a red tie and he has thick slicked back hair. He's definitely attractive.

VALENTINO SUIT GUY
I work in *finance*... y'know.

COLLEGE GIRL
That's amazingggg.

Lewis considers going in for a quick beer, then decides to pass and pursue in his search for a cab.

He puts on his headphones in order to have some kind of soundtrack while strolling through the city. One of those songs that he likes so much starts playing. It's one of those rap songs where there's a very minimal beat and guy spits over it with some very emotional lyrics, then closes the verse on a powerful one-liner leading the way for a big, beautifully sung hook. One of those.

Once he has surpassed the bar he notices a sad French restaurant on the other side. There's only a couple inside eating at candle-lit table, they seem happy, but from his prospective Lewis can spot the owner crying in the kitchen while she holds some bills and her husband tries to reassure her.

Lastly, at the end of this road, there's a diner. It's called "Fat Fairy Diner", which is not a great name, yet the place is packed.

Lewis is hungry, there's no denying that, he passed on the beer but he's going to grab some food.

Lewis turns the corner, puts away his headphones and enters.

INT. FAT FAIRY DINER - CONTINUOUS

Two girls who are sitting by the door abruptly interrupt their conversation to look at him entering.

They are not pleased and don't make anything to hide their disappointment, is not that Lewis is a bad looking guy, is just that is quite a mess tonight.

Lewis goes to the counter, he hears the girls laughing but when he turns to check, they are not even there anymore. Weird.

DINER LADY
What can I get you hon'?

LEWIS
Hi, yeah. A number 6 and... a number 17 please. Oh and a large coke if possible.

DINER LADY
Sure... just can't serve you the number 17.

LEWIS
Why not?

DINER LADY
Don't know, just can't.

LEWIS
Oh okay. A number 4 than.

DINER LADY
That's better. It's \$9.84 hon'.
(Lewis pays)
Find yourself a spot and I'll have it brought to you.

LEWIS
Thank you.

DINER LADY
Oh thank you sweetie.

"Go find a spot" is a task easier said than done, even the booth where the girls were sitting is once again occupied.

He looks around for an empty booth without striking any luck, so he opts for sharing a table with a guy who's sleeping with his head against the window and a hood on. He sits there and places his jacket on the seat opposite to himself.

His attention is caught by a couple happily sharing a meal at the next table, he looks at them with a cocktail of self-pity and envy.

WAITER #1
There you are... so... a number 4, a number 6 and a large coke, is that right?

LEWIS
(snapping out)
Yes, yes it is.

WAITER
Wonderful, there you go.

The waiter lays a tray with Lewis' food on the booth.

LEWIS
Can I ask you a question?

WAITER #1
Yeah sure.

LEWIS
Do you know where can I catch a cab
around here?

WAITER #1
I don't think you can my friend.

LEWIS
There aren't any around here?

WAITER #1
Oh no, usually I see many.

LEWIS
Then why can't I find one tonight?

WAITER #1
I haven't seen any tonight.

LEWIS
Well... that's weird.

WAITER #1
Is it?

Lewis is caught off-guard by the question. The waiter excuses himself and strides off. Lewis starts eating.

His meal consist in a burger, some onion rings and that large coke. He eats avidly, everything is good, fat, healthy, not in the absolute sense of the word, but healthy for him that was in desperate need of some nutrients.

WALKER
Hey man you mind if we share?

Same as before, over Lewis' right shoulder stands Walker, Lewis feels followed.

LEWIS

Have you... have you been following me?

WALKER

Oh my fucking God... you again. Nah man I ain't been following you. How many time I gotta say this. I'm not a robber.

LEWIS

I just find it hard to believe that I'm, by chance, meeting you again.

WALKER

Ain't a coincidence ever happened to you? My god man you saw me get on the bus.

Lewis shakes his head, Walker is right, he's just being a paranoid fuck.

LEWIS

Yeah sorry, please have a seat.

Lewis takes his jacket by his side and Walker sits in front of him.

Now they don't have many choices but to make at least some kind of small talk. To Lewis the thought is dreadful, Walker doesn't mind at all, although he is clearly not a fan of Lewis' yet.

WALKER

So what do you do for a living?

LEWIS

I'm a journalist.

WALKER

Really? What you write for?

LEWIS

Local paper.

WALKER

I figured. Which one?

LEWIS

You wouldn't have heard of it.

WALKER

Try me.

LEWIS
The "Here, Today, Weekly".

Walker laughs to let his thoughts on that paper be very clear.

WALKER
You the ones with the bluish paper,
ain't you?

Lewis nods and smiles, he concurs with Walker about the quality of the newspaper.

WALKER (CONT'D)
Very fucking bad name also, if I
may.

LEWIS
You have no idea how much I agree
with you.

WALKER
Tell me.

LEWIS
How can it be Here and Today, while
also being Weekly. Either it's
today or it's this week. It's
fucking retarded.

WALKER
HEY! HEY! Can't use that word no
more.

LEWIS
(emberassed)
No wait... I just... I didn't
mean...

WALKER
You just what? You didn't mean
what?

LEWIS
You're right... I'm sorry.

WALKER
(breaking tension)
Relax man, I'm just messing with
ya. It's nice to see you finally
not being scared of me.

LEWIS
Yeah sorry 'bout that, also.

WALKER
It's all right. You mind?

LEWIS
Not at all, go on.

Walker takes a big sip out of Lewis' coke.

WALKER
That's better, thanks...so...you
like working there?

LEWIS
Hate it.

WALKER
Why don't you quit then?

Lewis doesn't have a coherent answer, but the waiter comes with Walker's food and the perfect timing of the bell at the end of a round.

WAITER #1
Two 17s for you my man... there you
go.

That's not so perfect, is it?

Walker catches the weird look on Lewis' face as his order is laid in front of him. It's not the scared look he has had around him since they met, it's almost like... anger.

WALKER
(while taking a bite out
of the 17)
What's bothering you now?

LEWIS
I ordered a 17.

WALKER
That's a 4.

LEWIS
Exactly.

WALKER
I'm not following.

LEWIS
They said they were out of 17s.

WALKER
Sylvia said that?!

LEWIS
Who's Sylvia?

WALKER
(pointing at the counter)
Her.

LEWIS
Right. She didn't exactly say they
were out.

WALKER
What *did* she say?

LEWIS
That they couldn't serve it to me.

WALKER
There you go.

LEWIS
You know about this?

WALKER
About what?

LEWIS
About them not serving the food is
ordered.

WALKER
Oh no. Never heard of that. But I
get it.

LEWIS
I don't.

WALKER
Well you will.

Walker's last words don't even enter Lewis' ears. He's all
cooped in the thought of why they wouldn't serve it to him.

He's looking out the window, biting his nails, devouring
ideas while the ideas are actually devouring him.

WALKER
Don't do that.

LEWIS
What?

WALKER
Get inside your head.

LEWIS

I'm not.

WALKER

You very much are my friend, don't
lie to me.

(a beat)

Here... trade with me.

Walker slides his second dish to the other side of the table
while grabbing the few onion rings left.

WALKER (CONT'D)

That better?

LEWIS

Thanks but that's not the point.

WALKER

You gon'tell me what the point is?

Lewis doesn't answer.

WALKER (CONT'D)

Then eat your damn 17 and shut up.

Lewis closes himself up once again. Walker realizes he's
been a bit too harsh.

WALKER (CONT'D)

By the way. I didn't mean to be
rude. I just don't get it.

LEWIS

What is it?

WALKER

You wanna know why they didn't get
you what you wanted, go ask why.
Don't stay here rumbling in your
own thoughts.

LEWIS

Yeah, I guess you're right.

WALKER

You going to ask?

LEWIS

What? Right now?

WALKER

YEAH! Right now!

LEWIS
(scoffs)
Maybe later, okay?

WALKER
Fine. Fine. Maybe later. We'll see.

LEWIS
We'll see.

Out of the blue the man sleeping over the window wakes up.

He's all wrinkled up and confused, he looks like he's been sleeping for ages.

He jumps up the table and runs away, spilling Lewis' coke all over the booth

SLEEPING GUY
(running out of the
diner)
WHERE THE FUCK AM I? WHO THE FUCK
ARE YOU? FUCKKKK! FUCKKKK!

Lewis and Walker look in each other's eyes for the first time. Both in complete disbelief in regards to what just happened.

WALKER
What the fuck?

They both burst out laughing. It takes them a second to calm down.

WALKER
Hey, listen, feel free to say
whatever.

LEWIS
Shoot.

WALKER
You got any plans after this?

Besides finding a way to get home? Nah, besides that he's free as bird.

I/E. FAT FAIRY DINER - LATER

The two of them are about to exit the diner. Lewis goes first but Walker grabs him by the back of his collar and stops him.

WALKER
You sure you ain't gonna ask why?

LEWIS
Yeah man. Not worth it.

WALKER
It's only as worthy as it weighs on
your shoulders.

LEWIS
It doesn't. Like at all.

WALKER
Hey. Don't lie to me, I told you.
(a beat)
Let's get outta here, c'mon.

They exit the diner.

They stand on the corner, Walker takes a pack of cigarettes
out of his pocket.

WALKER
Want one?

LEWIS
No thanks. I only smoke when I
drink.

WALKER
Really bad habit.

LEWIS
Not as bad as smoking smoking.

WALKER
Fair point.

Lewis is starting to have second thoughts about hanging out
with Walker, or hanging out at all, he was already tired,
but eating got him sleepy.

LEWIS
You happen to know where I can find
a cab?

WALKER
Nope.

LEWIS
Of course.

WALKER
Just call one.

How has he not thought of that earlier?

He looks it up and dials. It rings.

WALKER
Where we goin'?

LEWIS
Ehm... I was just gonna go home and
get some sleep.

WALKER
You said you didn't have no plans.

LEWIS
I don't.

WALKER
Then why you tryna get home so
quickly? You got a girlfriend
waiting for you or somethin'?

LEWIS
I used to.

Lewis has responded instinctively. He immediately feels like
he has opened a window on his persona that he deeply wished
was kept close.

LEWIS
(to himself)
This damn companies.

WALKER
Try them later man, let's start
walking. Which way's your place?

Lewis points to his left, into an alley which is comically
dark compared to the street which he arrived from.

WALKER
That's gon' be nice.

Lewis hangs up then looks at Walker like "I know right?".

EXT. DARK ALLEY - CONTINUOUS

The alley is so dark that we can't see either of them, we
just hear their voices and the sound of the steps coming
towards us at the end of it.

WALKER
You comfortable with me now?

LEWIS
I figured if you were tryna hurt me
you would have hurt me already.

WALKER
What if I'm just tryna get to your
place?

LEWIS
Then the joke's on you 'cause you'd
be finding more valuable shit
getting what I have on, rather than
what I have at home.

WALKER
You that broke?

LEWIS
Never said I was broke.

WALKER
You either broke or very cheap my
man.

LEWIS
(scoffs)
Who knows eh?

Sound of running steps is heard right behind them.

LEWIS
You heard that?

WALKER
Heard what?

LEWIS
Someone running. Behind us.

WALKER
Running like towards us?

LEWIS
No. I mean... I don't know...
maybe?

WALKER
Nah man, haven't heard none o' that.

LEWIS
Can we hurry up at least?

WALKER
You're in charge.

Their pace accelerate.

LEWIS
What you mean by that?

WALKER
Just a joke, you should really
relax a little.

The running sounds is heard once again. Faster and faster,
approaching, like a horse galloping to the finishing line.

LEWIS
You hearing this now, right?

WALKER
Now I am.

They halt, uncertain. A wind hoovers over Lewis' shoulder.

LEWIS
(whispered)
I think it passed me.

The race continues in our direction. It gets closer by the
second.

CAMERA PUSHES TOWARDS THE END OF THE ALLEY.

BADUM. BADUM. BADUM. BADUM.

As the CAMERA reaches the edge of the alley a figure wearing
an all white suit and a plague doctor's mask pops out. It
looks straight into CAMERA then to his left, then to his
right and eventually runs away in that direction.

WALKER
Man I hate the fucking scum in this
city.

LEWIS
Was that fucking Khonshu?

WALKER
Who?!

EXT. THE FOLLOWING STREET - CONTINUOUS

They turned right, as "KHONSHU" did.

This street is quite narrow, they walk on one of the two brown paved sidewalks. Yellow light comes from the street-lamps.

WALKER

What were you saying about a girlfriend that "used" to wait for you?

LEWIS

Oh nothing, forget it.

WALKER

Come on, we gotta talk about something.

LEWIS

Can't we just pick another topic? Like... I don't know... hockey?

WALKER

We ain't gonna talk about hockey.

LEWIS

More of a basketball guy?

WALKER

Not really into sports.

LEWIS

Fuck. Ehm... I don't know...

WALKER

Choose. Either your girlfriend or your job. We ain't got much time.

LEWIS

We don't?

WALKER

No. We don't.

Lewis' not convinced, but decides to go along with it.

LEWIS

Let's go "Job for two-hundred".

Walker smiles.

WALKER

Okay... you seem like a smart guy, yet you work a job you hate, for little to no money...

LEWIS
(interrupting)
Hey! That's not true. I told you.

WALKER
Let me finish... yet you work a job
you hate, for little to no money...

Lewis looks at him eager for the bit's ending.

WALKER (CONT'D)
...why is that?

LEWIS
What is... Walker's an asshole?

WALKER
(laughing)
I'm just playing, just playing.
(a beat)
But seriously, why is that?

LEWIS
It's...I don't know... I grew up
here, graduated high school top ten
of my class, then I went and
studied screenwriting at NYU.

WALKER
You dropped out?

LEWIS
To the contrary, I graduated very
well, not top ten as in high
school, but still. You know?

WALKER
And then?

LEWIS
I try to be a screenwriter. I even
write a couple episodes for a web-
series. You know the "Crazy Cat On
The Roof"?

CUT TO:

A poorly drawn and animated white cat with long whiskers
stands on a stylized building roof.

CRAZY CAT
Let me tell you something about *JEW*
CATS.

CUT TO:

WALKER

Yeah. I'm all for freedom of speech
but I get why y'll got cancelled.

LEWIS

I didn't write that one.

WALKER

Bet.

LEWIS

As I was saying...I write these
episodes, then I get to be in the
writing room of a couple of sit-
coms.

WALKER

So it was going well, right?

LEWIS

It was all going too slow, bills
were starting to pile up, my ideas
were *constantly being* rejected or
worse, adapted. So yeah, I quit,
came back home, started working at
"Here, Today, Weekly" and now here
I am... walking home with some
stranger. No offense.

WALKER

None taken. You any good of a
writer?

They turn a corner to the left.

EXT. THE FOLLOWING STREET - CONTINUOUS

This one is a one-way street with car only coming from the
opposite direction. Sidewalk's completely different, black
as the concrete of the roadway, lights are placed inside
little cages carved in the adjacent buildings.

LEWIS

I believe so. Yeah.

WALKER

Then you should have stuck with it.

LEWIS

You think?

WALKER

If you were any good yeah, if you weren't then absolutely not. I've never read you, gotta go with what you say.

Lewis only then takes notice of how strangely built is the street they're walking on.

LEWIS

Wait. I don't think I've ever been here.

WALKER

I'm following you.

Lewis looks at his phone in order to make sure they're on the right path.

LEWIS

Yeah... should be right.

WALKER

But is it?

Walker looks at Lewis with staggering intensity, he stays on him for a second too long, it gets kind of creepy, kind of scary, but then he goes back to normal. Lewis shakes his head, he must have imagined it.

Further down the road there's a man, the "Khonshu" from before, pounding on a metal door. They haven't seen him yet, but they do when he starts screaming.

"KHONSHU"

GUYS! COME ON GUYS! YOU GOT TO LET ME IN! YOU STUPID FUCKING FUCKS!

WALKER

(To Konshu)

HEY! EVERYTHING ALL RIGHT?

Konshu turns his head seemingly by ninety degrees, then without a warning starts running in their direction. Lewis is paralyzed as if Medusa had just looked him straight in the eyes. Walker on the other hand seems very calm.

Konshu doesn't have any intention of stopping, he's going for Lewis' head. He's cocked his fist, he's about to strike when Walker's big left hand knocks him out cold. Lewis' about to faint.

Konshu's mask fall from his face, underneath there's just a kid not older than eighteen, the lights are completely out for him.

LEWIS
Did you fucking kill me?

WALKER
(joking)
Who's to say.

LEWIS
(kneeling to make sure
the kid's okay)
How are you so chill about this?

WALKER
What you worrying about?

The kid doesn't respond. Lewis puts a finger under his nose. He's breathing.

LEWIS
Thank God.
(turning to Walker)
He's just a kid.

WALKER
Who was gonna punch you in the damn
face.

LEWIS
You don't know that.

WALKER
You could just say "thank you
Walker".

LEWIS
For killing a kid?

WALKER
He ain't dead.
(to the kid)
Come on man stop playing!

As he finishes the sentences the kid's eyes pop right open. Wide open. Staring at the nightly sky. Then, like nothing happened, he pulls up Undertaker-style and puts his mask back on.

He stands right up without saying a word and lays his eyes on Walker, then on Lewis for a little longer. He even tilts his head as he's gazing at him.

Lewis closes his fist fearing another attempted strike, but the guy just walks away, back to where he came from.

Lewis and Walker watch him walk away, slow but steady. They think he's going home, or wherever, but his stroll comes to an end in front of the same door he was banging on before. He robotically rotate towards it and...

"KHONSHU"

GUYS! COME ON GUYS! YOU GOT TO LET
ME IN! YOU STUPID FUCKING FUCKS!

LEWIS

What the fuck?

Walker shrugs disinterested. The door in front of "Khonshu" opens, he disappears inside.

WALKER

Have you seen that?

LEWIS

Have you seen what?

WALEKR

(pointing behind Lewis)

That.

Walker is pointing at a bus stop a little further down the road in the opposite direction.

LEWIS

(confused)

Has it always been there?

WALKER

I think so. Wanna go check it out?

LEWIS

How much can it hurt?

Right?

EXT. BUS BENCH - MOMENTS LATER

Walker sits on the bench smoking, Lewis behind him studies the schedule board.

LEWIS

Only a certain 112 makes this stop
and if this thing is making any
sense, it does so in about... three
minutes. Can you see where it's
headed?

WALKER
Don't have a phone.

LEWIS
Who doesn't have a phone these days?

WALKER
Walker Glover doesn't.

LEWIS
Who's that?

WALKER
(disappointed)
Come on man. Be better.

LEWIS
Just kidding. I know he's that guy from Atlanta.

Walker smirks impressed.

WALKER
I think this bus will take you where you gotta be.

LEWIS
(checking his phone)
Yeah it does.
(joyous)
YEAH IT DOES! Not exactly, but still, close enough.

WALKER
Good for you.

LEWIS
Thanks man.

Walker nods to say it's nothing.

LEWIS
You going home now?

WALKER
No. Don't think so.

LEWIS
Where you going then?

WALKER

I don't know. There's many things
to do and plenty of time do 'em
all, I'll just wait for something
to come up.

LEWIS

That's a nice attitude.

(a beat)

You haven't told me anything about
yourself.

WALKER

You haven't asked anything.

A RAPID FIRE SEQUENCE OF EVERY QUESTION WALKER HAS ASKED
LEWIS IS PLAYED.

LEWIS

Yeah... I guess I didn't.

The 112 bus is seen approaching from the end of the street.

LEWIS (CONT'D)

I guess it's goodbye anyway.

WALKER

Stop guessing.

The 112 stops close to the bench. The bus' got tinted
windows, even the front one. On the hood the word "HILLS" is
written backwards, so that it can be read when reflected
on the window. The doors open in front of Lewis.

Lewis gives Walker a goodbye look, Walker reciprocates. He
then steps on the first of the stairs, he turns to get a
last glimpse of the man that has accompanied him up to that
point.

LEWIS

It was nice meeting you Walker.

WALKER

You too Lewis, you too. And who
knows... maybe our paths'll cross
again.

LEWIS

Maybe.

The doors close behind him. It's goodbye for real now.

INT. 112 - CONTINUOUS

Lewis goes up the last two steps and approaches the driver. The man is wearing a red beanie with a blue and white pompom on top, his shirt is placed on the back of his seat so that he is only wearing a white tank top while sitting behind the wheel. He's staying inside a plexiglass box with just a little opening at his face's height.

LEWIS
One ticket please.

BUS DRIVER
(RE: the bus seats)
Go on.

Lewis doesn't understand.

LEWIS
No. I mean... I need a ticket. I don't have one.

BUS DRIVER
You don't need one. It's free.

LEWIS
Really?

BUS DRIVER
Yeah. 112 policy. Go on have a seat.

LEWIS
(amused)
Well that's a good policy.

Lewis ambles to the seats all satisfied and happy, now believing to have finally found a way to get home. The bus is set in motion.

The first rows of seats are completely empty, but in the oddly darkened bus he can hear some clamor coming from the back. He starts weighting every step.

On his right a couple of guys in their thirties look like they have been heavily beat up. He goes past them. He looks back, he should have sat at the front, he knows it, but it's too late now.

The bus gets darker every step he takes. On his left a woman lays down with a cast full of signatures covering her leg. On his right, in front of the woman, another woman, a younger one, is sited with a wet cloth on her head. They are both complaining under their breath.

He goes a little further, he's went half across the bus, more or less, when...

A PERSON ON THE GROUND
AAAAAA! WHAT THE FUCK ARE YOU
DOING?!

Lewis jumps back terrified. He looks down where an old man is laying shirtless. Head to the front, feet to the back. So yeah. Lewis stepped on his face. A face which is kind of battered to be fair. Two black eyes, covered in dirt all over, dry blood on the forehead and on the cheeks.

LEWIS
GEEZ MAN! WHAT THE FUCK HAPPENED TO
YOU?

The man loudly pulls up, growling bestially. He's quite short yet fat. Although his chest is strangely untainted, his leg are also covered in bruises.

GUY WITH BLACK EYES
What the fuck is your problem?!

LEWIS
I'm sorry. I didn't see you.

GUY WITH BLACK EYES
I fucking noticed.

LEWIS
Again. I'm sorry. Are you okay man?

GUY WITH BLACK EYES
Fuck yeah. It'll take a lot more to
take down good ol' Ford.

LEWIS
That is you, right?

FORD
What are you? Stupid?

LEWIS
Can I please come through?

FORD
As you please.

Ford makes himself thin in order to let Lewis pass, unfortunately even making himself thin he occupies most of the corridor.

Lewis finally finds a free section close to where the clamor is still coming from. At this distance it sounds like people lamenting endlessly.

Lewis is about to sit down when the bus drastically MAKES A U-TURN. Screaming plunges all over the coach. Lewis stands up and looks out the window to see the landscape do a complete one-eighty.

The bus speeds up in the opposite direction, Lewis decides to go confront the driver when he catches the noises from the back coming forth. He turns around just in time to realize there's a crazy amount of injured people coming out of the dark, as if they were a zombie orde. They go over the seats, the squeeze each other in the passage way, Lewis is astonished, he wants to move, but his legs don't respond. The orde is getting closer, they are screaming all kind of profanities, where do all this people come from? Lewis glimpse to his sides, too late, zombie's have already started to trump over the nearby seats.

He closes his eyes and then BOM. They get him. The orde seemingly runs over him before claiming Ford too.

FADE TO:

INT. A KITCHEN - A HOUSE - AT A CERTAIN TIME

This kitchen is very tidy: white walls, white marble table, clear pine cabinets. Three windows, ergonomically distributed along the walls, allow the natural light to illuminate the place gracefully.

In the center of this painting, shoulder to us, stands a dark haired woman. She is next to the kitchen sink, in front of one of said windows and she's chopping on something. She cuts and cuts and cuts and every time the knife sinks her movements get a little faster, a little more decise.

The CAMERA takes a couple small steps to the left, in a way that makes us understand that she's not supposed to know she's been watched. Doing so we catch a glimpse of her pale face and upper body mirrored in the stainless glass.

Her eyes are red like she's been crying endlessly, her light blue apron has a teddy-bear in the middle which has a drop of blood in his right eye, the cutting board is overflowing with onions. She chops down reveling THE BLOODY KNIFE she's using.

She suddenly turns to us, so the CAMERA sneakily hides under the table... from where we get to see the a man's feet laying next to hers.

CAMERA slowly, with uncertainty, moves towards the head unveiling that the man is none other than... LEWIS!

We hear the sound of metal dropping onto other metal, probably the knife in the sink. She starts walking, her little heels trumpet on the hardwood, CAMERA follows her feet as she crosses the table and heads into the adjacent room.

INT. A LIVING ROOM - A HOUSE - AT SOME POINT

Lewis is sitting on the powder white couch playing a videogame with his feet on the coffee table. We only hear it's some kind of sports game, every other sound is blocked out. The daylight, coming from a large window on the door's right, is mitigated by a linen curtain. Lewis puts his feet back on the carpet and leans forward as the game is getting tougher.

LEWIS
(no sound)
Fuck!

A WOMAN (O.S.)
(breaking the "silence")
HONEY?!

Lewis doesn't respond to the call.

A WOMAN
LEWIS!

Lewis pauses and turns to the woman. She's holding the same knife as before.

LEWIS
What, Helen? What?

HELEN
I asked if it's okay if I make some onions to put on the side.

LEWIS
What?

HELEN
Onions.

LEWIS
You know I fucking hate onions.

HELEN
No you don't.

LEWIS
I fucking very much do hate onions.

HELEN
Since when?

LEWIS
SINCE FOREVER HELEN.

HELEN
Okay. Gee. Calm down. You don't
need to be so mean to me.

LEWIS
I wouldn't be so mean if you
listened to me once in a while.

Helen tightens her grip on the knife's handle. Then she lets
it fall on the ground.

LEWIS
Why would you that now?

Helen doesn't say a word. She's about to cry, she knows it,
but doesn't want to give him the satisfaction, so she just
looks at him in the eyes with vivid coldness, then...

HELEN
Go fuck yourself Lewis.

She fiercely strides to the door and storms out slamming it
behind her.

EXT. A PORCH - A HOUSE - WHENEVER

The wooden porch is adorned with yellow tulips, some
petunias and a few red poppies sprinkled here and there.

Helen is chilling on the porch swing, a little brown book in
a hand, a glass of rosé wine in the other. She seems to be
really enjoying herself.

A car stops in front of the little house gate and drops
Lewis off, he exits smiling and keeps doing it as he waives
to the departing car, but as soon as he feels no longer in
sight he drops the act. He loosens his tie, takes off his
grey jacket and assumes a generally contrite look. He goes
past the gate.

Helen is waiting for him with a smile from ear to ear
printed on her face, she's put down her book and almost
emptied her glass.

HELEN
How was your day sweetheart?

LEWIS
Awful. As always.

HELEN
Aww... I'm sorry to hear that.

LEWIS
Yeah.

Helen gets out of her seat and approaches Lewis for a kiss.

LEWIS
Have you been drinking?

HELEN
A couple of glasses of rosé, why?

LEWIS
Is there any left?

HELEN
I'm afraid not honey... but we can
open some white if you want.

LEWIS
No don't worry... it's okay.

Lewis kisses her gently, then notices the brown book left on
the swing.

LEWIS
You still reading that thing?

HELEN
It's impressive.

LEWIS
I strongly disagree.

HELEN
You are just too modest.

LEWIS
Many, *many* editors would disagree.

HELEN
That's 'cause they are a bunch of
stupid dumb idiots.

Lewis finally smiles, kisses her once again then opens the
door to get inside. He stops halfway through though.

LEWIS
Hey! Helen?

HELEN
Yes?

LEWIS
What's for dinner?

HELEN
Ehm... I actually haven't really
thought about it.

Lewis shakes his head, disappointed.

LEWIS
'course you haven't.

HELEN
(surprised)
What's that supposed to mean?

LEWIS
Nothing, forget it.

Lewis proceeds to get inside and closes the door behind him, he doesn't really slam it but it does so using more strength than he should have.

Helen doesn't understand, was she supposed to have dinner already figured it out? She doesn't think so, but now she looks saddened. She tries to go back to her book but can't even go through one page, she throws it away.

She's now staring at the empty space in front of her, her eyes begin to water... but it was nothing, she knows it, Lewis not only loves her, he values her.

She finishes her drink then, making sure Lewis' not in sight, she picks up the rosé bottle from under the swing. She pours herself another, voiding the bottle for real now and eventually rests her back on the swing.

CAMERA moves to find the little brown book resting on the floor, it ZOOMS to reveal the page on which the book has fallen; it reads: "I MISS YOU 'CAUSE YOU WERE MY HEART/I NEED YOU 'CAUSE WE GREW APART".

A MAN (O.S.)
HEY! HEY! WAKE UP! YOU ALIVE MAN?!

BACK TO:

INT. 112 - NIGHT

CU: LEWIS' CONFUSED FACE AS HIS STARING UPWARDS WHILE LAYING ON THE FILTHY BUS FLOOR.

He soon realizes there's someone towering over him, screaming. It's Ford.

FORD
Oh good! You are alive.

LEWIS
Yes. Yes I am.
(remembering what
happened)
What the fuck happened here?

FORD
What do you mean?

Lewis picks himself up from the ground.

LEWIS
Are you serious? The bus turning
around... the tidal wave of people
coming from the back that was
swallowing everything? They were
all kinda injured.

Ford looks at him like he's saying some crazy stuff.

LEWIS (CONT'D)
Don't look at me like that. You saw
what happened, you got under too, I
saw you.

FORD
You hit your head or something?

LEWIS
(rolling his eyes)
Fuck me...

FORD
(disgusted)
No thank you.

LEWIS
Oh my God... listen. Have you seen
were everybody went?

FORD
Everybody who?

LEWIS
Nothing man, let me through.

As before Ford tries to make himself thin while failing miserably. Lewis goes through, finally able to get out of the bus.

Before leaving the bus, he turns around to find Ford still there where he left him. Ford is just standing there like an out of power robot.

LEWIS
Hey Ford! Are you okay? You need me to call somebody?

FORD
Oh good! You are alive.

LEWIS
Yeah. Have a nice one man.

FORD
Oh you too. You too.

Ford goes back to "sleep". Lewis comes off the bus.

LEWIS

Now out of the bus tries to make heads or tails of the situation. He doesn't know where he is, he doesn't understand what happened on that bus and... check his pockets, yeah, his phone and wallet are now missing too.

He immediately thinks of running back on the bus to see if those are there, on the floor, but the doors close right in front of him. Lewis squints to check what's going on inside.

Behind the wheel sits Ford. He turns to Lewis, cheekily smiles at him then drives off.

Lewis bangs desperately on the bus as it runs away into the empty night.

Luckily enough the bus was hiding something. In the middle of this god-forgotten, dark, lonely road, there's a very cosy, very trendy-looking bar called "Gerry's Lounge".

Lewis takes a last quick scan of the nearby area so that, after having ascertained that there's absolutely nothing around, he crosses the road and heads towards the entrance of the lounge bar.

INT. GERRY'S LOUNGE - MOMENTS LATER

Inside the lounge bar there's a stage on which a singer is performing accompanied by a four-man band. She's singing "Dream A Little Dream Of Me". Surrounding the pulpit there's an ocean of round tables, all of which are occupied by heavy drinkers. Two women are quietly discussing the singer's talent while sharing a champagne bottle, two other emptied rest on their table.

WOMAN AT THE TABLE

She's very good.

OTHER WOMAN

She's butchering it.

WOMAN AT THE TABLE

Why do you always have to be such a bitch?

OTHER WOMAN

Fuck you know 'bout music?

WOMAN AT THE TABLE

Fuck you know 'bout music?

OTHER WOMAN

I dated Frank Sinatra's granddaughter cousin, remember?

WOMAN AT THE TABLE

You're full of shit.

OTHER WOMAN

Fuck you girl.

At this point the singer abruptly interrupts herself mid-song. All the lights inside the bar are shut down. People starts murmuring and asking each other what is going on.

SINGER

Ladies and gentlemen please bear with me in welcoming...

A bright spotlight is beamed opposite to the stage, where, just next to the entry, an almost blinded Lewis is looking around confused.

THE SINGER (CONT'D)

... a new guest.

All the crowd claps and cheers enthusiastically. Some people even throw their cloth napkins.

The follow-spot is turned off, the dim lights are brought back and singer reprise her song exactly from where she left off. The crowd goes back to listening and commenting as if nothing had happened.

LEWIS
(to a passing-by waiter)
They do this for everybody?

WAITER #2
The big welcome?

LEWIS
Yeah.

WAITER #2
I'd say three out of thirteen times.

LEWIS
Three out of thirteen?

WAITER #2
Yeah. Give or take a couple of specials.

LEWIS
Oddly specific.

WAITER #2
Well... that's Gerry's for you.

A man screams at the waiter to hurry up with his umpteenth drink.

WAITER #2
Gotta go, have a good evening sir.

LEWIS
Yeah, thanks, you too.

The waiter disappears in the labyrinth of tables, Lewis now at least knows the name of the bar.

He decides to go up to the bar and ask for some help. He wriggles in the small paths left open in between the humongous amount of tables squeezed inside such a small venue. He feels like everybody is looking at him. The majority of people don't even notice he exists but some are definitely shooting daggers at his clumsy walk through the floor.

At last he has almost reached his destination when his eyes are captured by a couple making out.

They are sitting right next to the bar counter, and her, from his prospective, looks a lot like HELEN.

LEWIS

Helen?

The couple is interrupted. The woman angrily turns around.

FRENCH WOMAN

(in French)

What do you want?

LEWIS

(in French but with a
very thick American
accent)

Pardon me, I thought you were
somebody else.

The woman shakes his head, so does her boyfriend.

THE BOYFRIEND

(in German)

Who's this?

FRENCH WOMAN

(in German)

A fucking idiot.

They restart their make-out session. Lewis self-consciously approaches the bar.

INT. BAR - GERRY'S LOUNGE - CONTINUOUS

A couple of bar-ladies are busy making and serving drinks to the various costumers, Lewis tries to make contact but can't reach them. He hunches over the counter in order to make himself more visible; from that position he notices a third bar-lady (amazing looking, 25ish) a little further down, she's not serving anybody nor she's taking any orders. In fact she's just standing there, in her beautiful cocktail dress, her hands on the wooden counter, her sight lost in the sea of people which flushes in front of her. Lewis thinks he definitely has to talk to her.

He can either take the scenic route, which means passing among the tables once again, or can squish and squeeze himself in between the people at the counter.

BAR-LADY

You need something sir?

LEWIS

Who? Me?

BAR-LADY
Yes sir, you.

LEWIS
Then no, thanks.

BAR-LADY
Wonderful. Then I'm gonna need you
to get off the counter, *sir*.

The emphasis placed upon that last *sir* convinces him to squish and squeeze to get to the lady. Which by the way is still standing there, exactly like she was moments ago.

LEWIS
Hi.

The lady is called back from her trance. She sees Lewis approaching from her right and smiles at him.

THE LADY
Hello sir, what can I get you?

LEWIS
Nothing thanks, I just need some
help.

She looks at him worried.

THE LADY
Sir this is not that kind of venue
and I'm going to have to say that
you are being very inappropriate.

Lewis instantly realizes his mistake.

LEWIS
Oh no. No. No. No no no. I meant to
say... I have a couple of
questions.

THE LADY
I can't talk to you unless you
order something.

LEWIS
And I absolutely get it, but I
don't have any money.

THE LADY
How come?

LEWIS
But you can ask question?

She laughs softly.

THE LADY
This one's on the house then...
(pointing at the ceiling)
...say thanks to Gerry.

A wolf head is hung right above him as if it were a very weirdly placed hunting trophy.

LEWIS
That him?

THE LADY
Yeah.
(a beat)
So what's your drink?

LEWIS
A Negroni please.

She starts preparing it.

THE LADY
Very good... it's Jane by the way.

LEWIS
Lewis, Lewis Gibson. And you?

JANE
Just Jane.

LEWIS
Nice last name.

She snorts in amusement, then serves him his drink.

JANE
So... what were your questions?

LEWIS
Yeah... ehm... where are we right now?

JANE
(pointing at ceiling,
confused)
At Gerry's?

LEWIS
No I mean... which part of town?

JANE
I can't really help you with
that... I don't live around here.

LEWIS
Do you know the name of the street?

JANE
Something like Tulip Street, can it
be?

LEWIS
(scoffs)
Sure it can but doesn't really help
me.

Jane fixes herself a Negroni.

JANE
What happened to you?
(bring up her glass)
Cheers.

They cheer.

LEWIS
Some weird things, but ultimately I
was robbed and ran over in a bus.
Other way around. Ran over and
robbed.

JANE
Oh my God! You were run over by a
bus?

LEWIS
Not by, *IN* a bus. It was fucking
unbelievable.

JANE
I bet?

Lewis smiles.

LEWIS
Yeah.
(a beat)
It's just...I lost my phone and my
wallet and I don't know where I am.
It's a really shitty evening.

JANE
You could borrow my boss' landline.
You know any phone number by heart?

LEWIS
A couple.

JANE
(flirty)
Any room for a third?

LEWIS
There might be.

As Jane starts giving her digits the drummer segues in to a very loud solo.

JANE
Don't forget it.

LEWIS
I won't.

JANE
Promise?

LEWIS
I'll do my best.

Jane twinkles knowing full well he will have forgotten it before their conversation is over. He does the same.

LEWIS (CONT'D)
So... where can I find your boss?

JANE
(pointing behind Lewis, a
bit to the left)
See that green door? Next to the
ivy plants?

LEWIS
Yeah.

JANE
Right there.

LEWIS
Is he always there?

JANE
Most of the time.

LEWIS
How many out of thirteen?

JANE
What?

LEWIS
Nothing. Should I knock?

JANE
I would.

LEWIS
Okay. Thank you so much Jane. I'll
call you if I ever manage get home.

JANE
I bet you will.

Lewis strides off to the green door. Jane amusingly observes him stumble between the booths, then proceeds to go back to her thoughts.

Lewis reaches the green door and...

EXT. MANAGER'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

TOCK TOCK.

No one answers. He knocks again, but the results are the same. He thinks of turning to Jane for confirmation but she can't see him anymore as she's lost in her mindless thinking.

Suddenly the door opens.

LEWIS
Hello?

SOMEONE INSIDE
Come through.

LEWIS
Sure?

The silence convinces him to enter. He walks in and the door automatically closes behind him. The room is apparently sound proof.

INT. LOBBY - MANAGER OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

It's pitch black. Lewis can't see a thing.

LEWIS
Hello? Is anyone here?

SOMEONE INSIDE
Go on. Can't open unless you knock.

LEWIS
Knock on what?

SOMEONE INSIDE
The door. It's a couple of steps
ahead of you.

Lewis walks some careful little steps until he slams on a cold door.

LEWIS
Ouch.

SOMEONE INSIDE
Please knock.

Lewis knocks. The door opens. Same as before.

INT. MANAGER'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

The office is heavily lit. White marble floor reflect the light onto the marble walls making it kind of difficult to keep the eyes open. The manager sits behind a huge, very tidy, wooden desk. In front of him is a black folder, he's wearing sunglasses and a white suit. It all looks expensive.

THE MANAGER
Please come in.

Lewis obeys. While entering he catches a glimpse of a couple of duffle bags laid on the black leather couch on the entrance's left.

THE MANAGER
First of all, have a seat my friend.

Lewis sits in the elegant office chair across the desk.

THE MANAGER
I'm Micheal. Micheal Muzzetti.
Double Z, double T. How can I help you?

Micheal offers his hand, Lewis half-stands and shakes on it.

LEWIS
Lewis Gibson, nice to meet you. I gotta say I'm kind of in a bad spot Mr. Museti.

MICHEAL
Please call me Mike. What kind of bad spot Mr. Gibsan?

LEWIS

So... I got on this bus that was supposed to take me home... but it took me here. The problem is... I don't know where *here* is, and I lost both my phone and my wallet.

MICHEAL

Was it the 112?

LEWIS

Yeah?

MICHEAL

See that happen sometimes.

The manager gestures to his right where, on the wall, are hung a bunch of pictures of guys that look like him, all of which are pretty confused. Lewis now has the same exact expression. Mike takes a picture of him with a disposable camera.

LEWIS

Okay... where are we then?

MICHEAL

At Gerry's Lounge of course.

LEWIS

(getting frustrated)

Of course... I meant which part of town?

MICHEAL

You know... like...

(making incomprehensible hand gestures)

...if the center's here... we're not exactly here, but a bit more right here? Am I making myself clear?

LEWIS

Not exactly Mike, no. Can't you look on your phone?

MICHEAL

We don't get Wi-fi in here...Hm... Let's try this. Where do you live?

LEWIS

In the Hills.

MICHEAL
The Hills?

LEWIS
Yeah, the Hills. You know?

MICHEAL
No. Never heard of them.

Lewis can't believe his eyes. He scratches them with his thumb and index. The image of Helen standing in front of the kitchen window flashes before him. He widens his eyes scared.

MICHEAL
Everything okay?

LEWIS
No Mike, not at all. Can you just call me a cab please?

MICHEAL
There aren't any cabs around here.

LEWIS
I'm definitely going crazy.

MICHEAL
What?

LEWIS
Nothing. Can I make a call?

MICHEAL
You only got one.

LEWIS
Hm?

Micheal pushes the phone to Lewis, he starts dialing then takes the handset to his ear.

PETER (O.S.)
Hello? Who's this?

LEWIS
Hey Pete. It's me.

PETER (O.S.)
Lew? What number is this?

LEWIS
Long story. Can you look something up for me real quick?

PETER (O.S.)
Sure thing Lew.

LEWIS
Gerry's Lounge. It's a bar. Where
the fuck is it?

PETER (O.S.)
Wait a sec...

The manager starts looking worried, he didn't like that last question.

PETER (O.S, CONT'D)
There's no such thing as Gerry's
Lounge.

LEWIS
The fuck you mean there's no such
thing? I'm right here.

PETER (O.S.)
Then why do you need me to look it
up?

LEWIS
Fuck. Gerry's with a G, you put a J
maybe?

PETER (O.S.)
No I put a G. The fuck's goin' on
Lew?

LEWIS
I can't get home Pete. I lost my
phone, lost my wallet, I don't know
where the fuck I am.

PETER (O.S.)
Just call the the cops man.

LEWIS
The cops?!

Micheal maliciously looks at the duffle bags then snatches
the phone from Lewis' hands.

MICHEAL
(into the headset)
Thank you so much, byeee.
(to Lewis, angrily)
You need to get out.

LEWIS
What? Why?

MICHEAL
Get. The fuck. Out.

LEWIS
But...

MICHEAL
No. No but. Get out. I'll come out
in a minute, if you're still there
I'll fucking turn you into a golf
course. Got it?

The door opens behind him, Lewis basically runs out.

INT. GERRY'S LOUNGE - MOMENTS LATER

Lewis once again pushes through the crowded room and reaches the bar, he makes a couple of drinks fall from the tables in the meanwhile. He frantically looks around, searching for Jane. She's not behind the counter, but pops up right behind him.

JANE
Looking for me?

LEWIS
(antsy, checking the
green door)
You got a phone?

JANE
What's goin' on?

LEWIS
No time. You got a phone?

JANE
Yeah. In the locker, why?

LEWIS
Can you get out of here?

JANE
You looking to kidnap me Lewis
Gibson?

LEWIS
(grabbing her shoulders)
Jane. If I don't get out of here
immediately your fucking boss is
gonna turn me into a fucking golf
course.

JANE
(understanding the
situation)
Shit.

LEWIS
So? Can you get out?

JANE
Yeah. Meet me behind the building.
I'll grab my phone and meet you
there.

LEWIS
You sure?

The green door opens up, Jane notices.

JANE
Get the fuck out.

Lewis realizes the door has opened so he goes ahead and
flies to the exit door.

Micheal comes out of his office with a shotgun in hand, but
a quick scan tells him the guy has left. People around look
at him with suspicion.

MICHEAL
(as if he were not
holding a shotgun)
How are we doing ladies and
gentlemen? Everything all right?

EXT. BEHIND THE BUILDING - LATER

Lewis walks anxiously up and down the alley. The little
rusty door behind Gerry's doesn't seem to be opening.

LEWIS
Fuck. Fuck fuck fuck. Fucking
fuckous fuck.

HELEN (O.C.)
(whispered)
Lewis?

Lewis jumps as if he were a cat who got his tail stepped on. He searches the alley with his eyes but there's no-one there, certainly not Helen.

Creaking noises announce the opening of the Lounge's back door. Lewis once again jumps as if he'd seen a ghost.

JANE
You okay?

LEWIS
Yeah, you just startled me.

JANE
That's not it.

LEWIS
Yeah it's not.

JANE
You wanna tell me?

LEWIS
It's just been a crazy fucking night.

JANE
Sure looks like it.

EXT. BUS BENCH IN FRONT OF GERRY'S - MOMENTS LATER

They are sitting on the bench. Jane's got her phone in hand.

LEWIS
(noticing her sleeveless dress)
Aren't you cold?

JANE
Not really, are you?

LEWIS
No. Not really.

JANE
C'mon gimme your number.

LEWIS
Okay?

JANE
I know you don't remember it.

LEWIS

Well...

He visibly tries to squeeze it out of his brain.

LEWIS

No. You're right, I don't. Mine
is...

As Lewis starts giving his number a passing truck blocks the
sound by blowing his horn.

JANE

Okay so that's sorted out. Where do
you live?

LEWIS

Up in the Hills.

JANE

Yeah. The address. I can't just put
in "The Hills" and expect something
to happen.

LEWIS

That's right. So...

The truck passes once again trumpeting over Lewis' words.

LEWIS

Was that the same truck?

JANE

I think so.

LEWIS

You got it?

JANE

Right by the stop for the 71?

LEWIS

Yeah.

JANE

Why didn't you take that?

LEWIS

It's not going tonight.

JANE

Right.

LEWIS
You knew that?

JANE
Yeah. I think somebody at work was
talking about it.
(looking at the phone)
So... it says it's a two hour and
thirty-eight minutes walk from
here.

LEWIS
What? Are you being serious? That
can't be right.

Jane smudgly turns her phone to Lewis.

LEWIS
Where the fuck are we? I didn't
even know this part of town
existed.

JANE
You new in town?

LEWIS
I grew up here.

JANE
Then I guess you didn't explore it
that much.

LEWIS
I guess I didn't.
(a beat)
Listen...can you just call the cops
for me and I'll figure it out with
them?

JANE
Yeah...only I don't think it'll be
that great of an idea to call them
from here.

LEWIS
Why not?

JANE
You tryna be a golf course?

LEWIS
I would gladly avoid that if
possible.

JANE
Then let's call them from my place.

LEWIS
I thought you didn't live around here.

JANE
Yeah. I lied. In my defense I thought you were a creep.

LEWIS
Have I cleared your doubts now?

JANE
About being a creep? Yeah. I still think you are crazy.

LEWIS
You might not be so out of mark on that point.

JANE
So... you wanna go?

LEWIS
Sure thing. Let's go.

They stand up and start walking down the road while staying in the middle of the street.

CAMERA STAYS ON BENCH AND JUST OBSERVES THEM SWINGING IN THE NIGHTLY SILENCE.

LEWIS
(fading)
So what's your real last name?

JANE
(fading more)
It's Just.

LEWIS
(almost impossible to hear)
Your last name isn't Just.

They fade away in the distance, laughing.

EXT. JANE'S APARTMENT - LATER

CAMERA STAYS on the apartment's door. It's the 321.

LEWIS (O.C.)
That it?

JANE (O.C.)
Yeah.

LEWIS (O.C.)
(as Jane picks up the
keys)
Three. Two. One...

Jane pushes the door.

INT. JANE'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

The apartment is very small but cozy. The door opens next to the kitchen, which a counter divides from the living room. In the latter a spanish woman, SONIA, is sitting on the brownish old couch with a little girl (4 ca.) sleeping with her head on her legs. The TV is pretty loud, something in Spanish is on.

JANE
(quietly)
Hola Sonia.

Jane takes off her heels as soon as she enters. Lewis doesn't say anything. He's uncertain about what he's supposed to be doing.

Sonia turns around surprised to see Jane home so early.

SONIA
Hola señorita Jane! ¿Qué hace' en
casa tan temprano?

JANE
Don't worry Sonia. Everything okay
with Haley?

SONIA
Si. Si. Ella e' siempre muy bonita.
Muy calma.

JANE
(smiling)
That's good.
(a beat)
You mind bringing her to bed before
leaving?

SONIA
Vale.

Sonia picks up little HALEY without waking her up then heads to the bedrooms. She passes through the door next to which Lewis is standing in awe of the intercultural exchange that just happened.

LEWIS
Is that..?

JANE
My girlfriend? Yeah.

LEWIS
Really?

JANE
I'm kidding. She's my nanny.

LEWIS
How old is she?

JANE
I'd say about forty-five, maybe fifty, something in that range.

LEWIS
Very funny. I meant the kid.

JANE
(proud)
She's just turned four.

LEWIS
She's beautiful.

JANE
(very proud)
Yeah. She is.

Sonia comes out of the door.

SONIA
La niña e'tà en la cama.

JANE
Thank you Sonia.

SONIA
E' un placer señorita.

Jane takes three different dollar bills from her purse on the counter and gives them to Sonia. She immediately gives two of them back.

JANE

Sonia...

SONIA

Solo necesito para el gua'gua'.

JANE

You always do this. Next time I'm leaving them in your jacket.

Sonia smiles tenderly and caresses her face.

SONIA

Buena' noche' señorita. Buena' noche' señor Lewis.

LEWIS

Buenas noches to you too.

Sonia leaves.

LEWIS

Did I introduce myself?

JANE

I think so.

LEWIS

You sure?

JANE

How else would she know your name?

LEWIS

Right.

But that's not right. He's pretty sure he didn't introduce himself.

LEWIS

She doesn't really pronounce her S'.

JANE

That's 'cause she's from La' Palma'.

Lewis doesn't understand what's that supposed to mean.

JANE (CONT'D)

Listen. I'll go change into something a bit more comfortable. Then we'll call the cops, okay?

LEWIS
Yeah sure.

JANE
Perfect. In the meantime... make
yourself at home.

Jane enters the same door Sonia entered before.

Now alone in the apartment Lewis' attention is drawn to the TV. He decides to get closer to it.

NARRATOR ON TV
En el próximo "Desarrollo
Detenido".

Lewis tilts his head.

INT. MIGUEL'S MODEL HOME - DAY

MIGUEL's brother JOB is standing in front of him wearing a cape and tuxedo pants.

MIGUEL
(exasperated)
Es esto uno de tus trucos?

JOB
Yo no tengo trucos Miguel. Yo tengo
ILUSIONES.

JOB throws some firecrackers to the floor producing a flebile smoke cloud. CAMERA pans on Miguel faces as he sees the top of his brother's head sticking out from behind the couch.

BACK TO:

INT. JANE'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

Jane enters once again, now wearing grey sweatpants and a large hoodie with the Las Palmas' soccer team logo in the middle.

LEWIS
(RE: the TV)
Is this..?

JANE
A total rip-off? Absolutely, but
Haley loves it.

LEWIS
I feel like I dreamt about
something like this once.

JANE
In Spanish?

LEWIS
In Spanish.
(a beat)
Haley speaks it?

JANE
A bit. Step by step. Sonia's
teaching her.

LEWIS
She's a smart kid.

JANE
I would be modest and say that is
all her father, but why lie?

LEWIS
He's not around much?

JANE
He does his best. Let's put it that
way.

LEWIS
Is that enough?

JANE
It has to be. It wouldn't be fair
to ask from a person more than that
person can give, would it?

LEWIS
Never thought of it that way.

JANE
Many don't.

Lewis looks down, Jane turns off the TV.

JANE
So... you ready to go home?

For the first time Lewis had actually forgotten about that
slight inconvenience.

CAMERA pushes on Lewis' empty face, CAMERA continues to push
on to his eyes then suddenly REVERSE TO find...

INT. CAR - DAY

Helen sitting next to Lewis. He is driving while she's all curled up in her seat, looking a bit off.

RADIO

And now a word from today's
sponsor...

Lewis shuts it off.

LEWIS

How are you feeling?

HELEN

Better.

LEWIS

You sure?

HELEN

Yeah. Thank you.

Lewis puts a hand on her leg and smiles at her. She doesn't reciprocate.

HELEN

Sorry about this morning.

INT. HOTEL ROOM - THAT MORNING

Lewis is sitting on the bed ready to leave, a packed suitcase on his right, an opened one on his left, it's Helen's. She's in the bathroom.

LEWIS

HELEN?

HELEN

ONE SECOND!!

LEWIS

Are you okay?

HELEN

Yes don't worry. I'll be there in a second.

LEWIS

Helen we were supposed to have left twenty minutes ago.

HELEN

Lew. I know. Gim...

(MORE)

HELEN (CONT'D)
 (she weirdly pauses)
 ..me a second.

A CLEANING LADY knocks on the door.

CLEANING LADY
 Mr. Gibson?

LEWIS
 HELEN!!

LEWIS
 I'm...
 (again the pause)
 ...coming.

BACK TO:

INT. CAR - DAY

LEWIS
 Are you kidding? If you had told me
 you were feeling sick, I could've
 at least packed your stuff, or
 talked to the manager...

HELEN
 Again, I'm sorry.

LEWIS
 No... that's not what I meant.
 Fuck. Just let me know if you need
 anything.

They pass a sign for a gas station five miles ahead.

HELEN
 (RE: the sign)
 Can we stop there for a minute?

LEWIS
 Sure baby.

HELEN
 (sweetly)
 Thanks.

EXT. SERVICE STATION - LATER

Lewis' car stops by the gas pumps. Helen hops out.

HELEN
 It'll be just a second.

INT. CAR - CONTINUOUS

Lewis' watches her enter the station. A couple of guys standing by the door check her out, he shakes his head then lets it rest.

Suddenly his phone chimes. He picks it up, he's got mail but decides to not check it right away so he puts it back down.

He goes back to waiting when the phone lights up again.

It's a message from a certain D. It says:

D.
Got yours?

He writes back:

LEWIS
Yeah.

D.
And...?

D.
??

LEWIS
I haven't read it.

D.
What?

LEWIS
I'll read it later.

D.
I got in btw.

LEWIS
Good for U.

D.
Yeah right.
Check that fucking e-mail.

Lewis lays the phone down again. Now with frustration. He's about to touch the headrest when...BRR BRR.

D.
Go on.

Lewis surrenders and goes to check his e-mail. The one at the top is from a "COMMITTEE FOR THE...". He opens it and:

"Dear Mr. Gibson, unfortunately we find ourselves obliged to refuse your application as your screenplay does not match the standards set by our notable...".

He stops right there and throws the phone against the passenger window. He then hits the honk violently a couple of times, ultimately he throw himself on the seat and puts his hands on his face. He's the embodiment of disappointment, frustration and anger.

At that very moment Helen comes back from the service station. She looks like she's cried at least a little bit, but as soon as she notices Lewis, she puts something in her pocket and snaps out of it.

HELEN
(entering the car)
Hey! What happened?

LEWIS
(with the hands still on
his face)
I didn't get it Helen.

She instinctively hugs him, putting his head on her chest. He starts sobbing.

EXT. HELEN'S HOUSE - LATER

It's the same house we've seen before, when she was sitting on the swing in the porch, just from different prospective.

Lewis stops the car by the small gate. He looks at her still shook from before. She kisses him softly and grabs his hand.

HELEN
It's gonna be okay.

LEWIS
(looking down)
You don't know that.

HELEN
(squeezing his hand)
Yes. Yes I do.

He shows signs of a smile under his breath.

She exits the car and goes to get her luggage. Lewis looks at her in the rear-view mirror. At least he's got her.

Before entering she timidly knocks on the front right window, he rolls it down.

HELEN
I didn't want to say anything until
I was sure but...

LEWIS
But?

She points at her belly.

LEWIS
(enthusiastically)
BUT?!

Her eyes begin to water, she nods. Now his eyes water too.

LEWIS
ARE YOU FOR REAL?

She takes a pregnancy test out from her pocket.

Lewis jumps out the car and runs at her, he picks her up and swings her around while kissing her forehead.

LEWIS
I can't believe it!

HELEN
(crying)
It's true.

LEWIS
I love you so much Helen.

HELEN
I love you too.

They kiss and...

JANE (V.O.)
Lewis? You all right?

BACK TO:

INT. JANE'S APARTMENT - AS BEFORE

Lewis is suddenly woken up from the memory he had found himself in. He's frightened and confused.

LEWIS
What?

JANE
I asked you if you were ready to go
home and you... you kinda left this
Earth for a second.

LEWIS
I guess I got a little in my head.
(a beat)
I really need to get home.

JANE
Yes, you do, c'mon.

Jane goes to the kitchen counter, Lewis takes a deep breath
but stumbles while exhaling. He almost falls down but
manages to stay up relying on the couch.

JANE
(seeing Lewis holding
himself up)
HEY! You okay?

Lewis looks at her but his sight starts to fade.

JANE
Lewis?

Lewis' eyes start closing, he mutters something. Jane
worryingly runs to his aid but that's the last thing Lewis
gets to see before passing out.

CAMERA CLOSES ITS LENSE AS LEWIS CLOSES HIS EYES.

INT. HOSPITAL WAITING ROOM - LATER

Jane is sitting alone in one of the chairs, she's on the
phone.

JANE
Thank you so much Sonia, I'll be
home as soon as I can.
(Sonia reassures her)
Okay, thank you again, I'll see you
later...bye Sonia.

Jane hangs up. A doctor comes through the door, she stands up
and advances towards him. He looks undisturbed.

DOCTOR
You came in with him?

JANE
Yes. Is he all right?

DOCTOR
Yes, everything's fine. He just got
a bit burnt out, he's resting now.

JANE
That's good. Anything else?

DOCTOR
One more thing.

JANE
Yes?

DOCTOR
We failed to reach his emergency
contact, a certain "Helen Carsi",
you know her?

JANE
I really just met him tonight. I'm
sorry.

DOCTOR
I see... well... he's not up but if
you'd like to say goodnight or just
stay in there for a minute, he's in
room forty-four.

JANE
Okay, thanks.

DOCTOR
Now if you'll excuse me.

JANE
Oh sure thing, have a goodnight
doctor.

DOCTOR
You too miss...?

JANE
Jane. Just Jane.

DOCTOR
Have a goodnight miss Jane.

The doctor leaves the room from the opposite door, Jane goes
through the one from which he entered.

INT. ROOM 44 - MOMENTS LATER

Jane quietly makes her way in to the room, Lewis is sound
asleep. The nightly news are on TV at a very low volume.

His tie, shirt and jacket are folded on the night stand. She looks at him with the mixture of tenderness and pity you would give to a sick child.

JANE

Poor guy...

As if those word were those of a magic spell, they trigger Lewis to wake up all of a sudden. Jane leaps back confused.

JANE

You up?

LEWIS

(all body still, looking
left and right)

Where the fuck am I?

JANE

You passed out.

LEWIS

Where. The. Fuck. Am. I?

JANE

You're at St. Mary's...

Hearing that location is another trigger for Lewis, as Jane continues talking his mind starts roaming. He doesn't listen to a single word she says, although he hears them all.

JANE (CONT'D)

...you passed out on my floor so I called an ambulance, they took you here. Doctor said you're fine, that it was some kind of *burnout*, you just need some rest, you know? It'll be fine.

(a beat, then remembers)

He also said they tried calling a certain Hellen something, but she wouldn't pick up, that your mom or something?

That name breaks through the shield. Lewis immediately rises from the bed. He stares at her with confusion and a bit of inexplicable anger.

LEWIS

What did you say?

JANE

You passed out on my floor.

LEWIS
Not that.

JANE
(not understanding)
You just need to rest?

LEWIS
THE NAME JANE. You said a name.

Jane hadn't seen this side of Lewis, she takes a further step back. This is the "enraged out of fear" side.

JANE
Hellen something?

LEWIS
Is she here?

JANE
What? No. Dude are you deaf?

Seeing Helen not back down brings Lewis closer back to the ground.

LEWIS
Fuck. Sorry. I can't stay here.

JANE
You need to rest.

LEWIS
I need to fucking get to my house.

JANE
The doctor said you need to rest.

LEWIS
Doctors are not perfect are they?

Jane doesn't know what to say. What is this guy's problem with doctors now?

Lewis' now going around the room like a maniac, he's looking for something.

JANE
HEY!

He doesn't respond in anyway.

JANE
(louder)
HEY MAN!

A swing and a miss.

JANE
(firm, authoritarian)
LEWIS GIBSON!

That he hears.

JANE (CONT'D)
You need to calm the fuck down.
What are you looking for?

LEWIS
My shit.

JANE
What shit?

LEWIS
My phone and shit.

JANE
You lost all your shit.

LEWIS
What? Where?

JANE
You said on a fucking bus.
Remember?

LEWIS
(scratching his head)
That was fucking real?

JANE
So it seems.

LEWIS
Fuck... Gotta get outta here.

JANE
I ain't gonna stop you, but I
really think you should stay.

LEWIS
I'm not staying in this hospital
for one second more than the time I
need to get out.

JANE
It's a free country.

Lewis picks up his clothes and takes off. Jane considers her option for a second, shakes her head, disappointed in herself, then follows.

JANE
(exiting)
Fucking wait a second Lewis.

I/E. HOTEL LOBBY - LATER

The lobby is completely deserted. Ceiling lights are off. It's quite the scary setting since the only light source is a small lamp sitting at the vacant reception and it radiates in a way that elongates and distorts every shadow.

Jane and Lewis arrive from the elevator and start walking towards the exit across the room.

JANE
You would think that some kind of check-out would be needed. Some form, a couple of signatures...

LEWIS
It's a bad fucking hospital, that's what it is.

JANE
Yeah but why is no one here?

LEWIS
How late is it?

JANE
Not that late.

LEWIS
It's a bad fucking hospital.

They go through the sliding doors and finally reach the outside.

In front of the hospital there's a rectangular square. The long sides are adorned with trees placed upon low walls, meanwhile one short side is the entire length of the hospital's front and the other is like the long ones but with a narrow passage for people to access.

There's a street-lamp at each corner but only the right ones work.

JANE
At least the square is nice.

LEWIS

It's not practical. It's a facade.
A joke. A hospital needs to save
people, all of them, not look nice.

JANE

My god Lewis... it's like an hour
in this place sucked the life outta
you.

Lewis freezes. Jane walks off for a second then notices he's
stopped.

JANE

What now?

He looks to the ground and scoffs while shaking his head.

JANE

Oh my fucking god, what's happening
now?

She's walking back when...

LEWIS

I lost my daughter here, Jane.

Now is Jane's turn to freeze.

CAMERA stays on her afflicted and pained face as Lewis walks
away. He passes the little passage between the trees while
she's yet to move a muscle.

EXT. VARIOUS STREETS - CONTINUOUS

LEWIS is now walking through the obscure night, once again
alone, once again uncertain in regards to what steps he is
supposed to take next.

All the situations that have been toying with him since he
left work have felt like a very specific form of torture,
laid upon him from a greater force above. The very fabric of
reality itself is starting to dissolve at the rhythm of his
shoes thumping on the pavement.

He doesn't even know what time it is, he doesn't even know
if time is still a thing. He's just walking, his mind shut
off, his eyes wide shut.

Nobody is out, not even a car is passing by, he makes a
left, but he could have just as easily made a right and it
wouldn't have made any difference. Would it?

CAMERA slowly but steadily elevates itself in order to show the endless labyrinth of same-looking streets that lays ahead of him. From this prospective we can see how the street lights get progressively less intense as the labyrinth grows further from Lewis.

He's about to make another meaningless turn when, roughly at the middle of the street length, a door opens and a MIDDLE AGED BLACK WOMAN comes out, we'll find out she's named ARIADNE.

ARIADNE
(screaming)
WHERE YOU GOING KID?

She hits him like a sniper with that question, right in the brain. Only this bullet will bring him back to life.

He turns around, from that distance he can barely see whether the person who just shouted is a man or a woman. He points at himself to ask "Who? Me?", but who else would it be?

ARIADNE
(same as before)
YEAH YOU! COME HERE!

Lewis would rather not, but at this point he has totally given up.

He starts strolling back, she sits on the stairs leading to her house and starts smoking a cigarette.

EXT. ARIADNE'S HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

Lewis arrives. He looks ten times worst than when we first met him and he already wasn't at this best back then.

Ariadne has thick grey dreadlocks, she's wearing a large black sweater and sweatpants with paint stains all over. Despite her recent screams, she has a very chill vibe about her.

ARIADNE
So? Where are you going young man?

LEWIS
(scratching his head)
Home, I guess.

She offers him a cigarette, he takes it this time.

ARIADNE
Who's home?

LEWIS
(pointing where he was
going)
Up in the Hills.

ARIADNE
No. I asked you who's home, not
where.

LEWIS
(perplexed)
Ehm... nobody. I live alone.

ARIADNE
That's not what I meant.

LEWIS
I'm not sure I'm following ma'am.

She smiles at him tenderly, she's the first person he's met
all night that hasn't pitied him from the start.

ARIADNE
(pointing behind herself)
See this door?
(he nods)
That's my house door.
Inside...inside is my house. It is
not my home. It's where I live, not
where I belong. You get me?

Lewis is not sure.

ARIADNE (CONT'D)
My son. In LA. My husband, may he
rest in peace. Those are my home.

LEWIS
(starting to understand)
I see...

ARIADNE
I will get home, eventually. One
home or another. My son, you know,
is doing his best and every time he
sends a check... I feel a little
less.

Lewis draws kind of a concerned face.

ARIADNE (CONT'D)
I don't wanna be a burden to him,
y'know?
(MORE)

ARIADNE (CONT'D)
I want him to be happy and rich and
healthy, I don't want him going
around being concerned about
feeding his mama.

LEWIS
(instinctively)
He's just taking care of his home.

ARIADNE
So you do get me.

LEWIS
I think I do now ma'am.

ARIADNE
I'm Ariadne, young man.

LEWIS
Lewis, nice to meet you.

They shake hands. Her hand looks older than she is.

ARIADNE
If you do get me then... what are
you doing going that way?

LEWIS
I need to go get some sleep, it's
been a crazy night.

ARIADNE
And let me tell you... it shows.

Lewis chuckles softly in a way that radiates his face.

ARIADNE (CONT'D)
But is that what you wanna do?

LEWIS
It's what I need.

ARIADNE
Is it?

LEWIS
Is it not?

ARIADNE
I don't know... I just know it's a
long way up to the Hills.

LEWIS
I already walked there from the St.
Mary's before.

ARIADNE
I'm sorry to hear that.

Lewis feels like she somehow knows what he's talking about.

ARIADNE
You do as you please Lewis. Go to
the Hills, go home, it's your
choice. Just don't walk there,
you've walked too much already.

LEWIS
How else am I going to get there?
There are no cabs, no busses... I
just got my feet.

ARIADNE
You are always alone when you keep
telling yourself that you are, you
know that.

LEWIS
My mom used to tell me that.

ARIADNE
She must be a smart woman.

Lewis agrees.

ARIADNE
(standing up)
I'm gonna go now Lewis.

LEWIS
Have a good night Ariadne.

Ariadne smiles at him while going up the stairs. She's about
to open the door when...

LEWIS
Ariadne wait!

She stops.

LEWIS
You know what time is it?

ARIADNE
Not too late, hopefully...
Goodnight Lewis.

LEWIS

Goodnight... I hope you'll get home
someday.

ARIADNE

Oh I will son, I will.

She enters her house.

Lewis looks back to the empty street and breaths deeply, a little bit of hope sparks up in his eyes but it's rapidly crushed by the weight of his own "realistic" thoughts.

Now he's almost convinced to continue in the direction he was taking before, and he would really go but fortunately...

JANE

THERE YOU FUCKING ARE!

LEWIS

Jane?

Jane is at the end of the street, the end from which he came. She seems to be in a big hurry.

JANE

I FOUND A FUCKING CAB! CAME ON!

LEWIS

A cab?

JANE

LEW! A FUCKING CAB! RUN! HE'S
WAITING FOR US.

He looks back at the door, a little "thank you" escapes his mouth and brings back a silent "It's nothing".

He then starts running to Jane.

MOMENTS LATER

A yellow, old, beat cab is parked next to the curb, it's waiting for Lewis and Jane.

The TAXI DRIVER is rhythmically tapping on the steering wheel, his hands are those of an old man. We do not get to see his face yet, but get the feeling that he's getting impatient.

He checks the rearview mirror but nobody is in the frame, so he rolls down the window, takes a cigarette out of his pack of camels and starts smoking.

AT THE SAME TIME

Jane and Lewis are running as fast as they can to reach that cab.

JANE
I just wanted to say that I'm
sorry.

LEWIS
For what?

JANE
You know... for before... I didn't
know...

LEWIS
How could you? It's okay.

JANE
Yeah but... I can't imagine... I
don't know... I'm sorry.

Lewis realizes that Jane isn't looking at him, she's
embarrassed. He stops.

LEWIS
Jane!

JANE
(stopping too)
Yes?

LEWIS
Thank you.

JANE
Thank you?

LEWIS
Yeah. Thank you. I left you there,
like an asshole, you didn't have to
come save me, but you did. Thank
you.

JANE
I wouldn't have been able to go
home knowing you were wondering
around like that.

Lewis is starting to really like this girl, he's seeing that
now.

JANE (CONT'D)
But seriously... we gotta run, I
left him right around this corner.

The race restarts.

They turn the corner and finally reach the cab.

They jump in.

INT. TAXI - CONTINUOUS

They both sit in the back, breathing heavily.

JANE
(panting)
Thank you for waiting.

TAXI DRIVER
It ain't no problem. Where to now?

In saying that he looks back at them.

He's pretty old, around seventy, but it's not the kind of man that would be considered in any way frail. Although clearly not in his prime anymore, the man shows remarkable signs of previous handsomeness.

You can tell by the shadows in the back of his eyes that he's a man who has seen plenty, if not it all. A subtle grin appears on his face, it does so in a way that emanates charisma, it is a grin that brings you closer, gets you in.

LEWIS
To ...

A speeding ambulance siren renders Lewis voice inaudible for us.

LEWIS (CONT'D)
... please.

TAXI DRIVER
654 and Baltimore it is.

The driver steps on the pedal and takes off.

JANE
You sure you don't wanna get home first?

LEWIS
Yeah. I'm sure.

JANE
We're probably closer to your place
anyway.

They are.

LEWIS
(with a hint of sorrow)
I don't think so... plus you got
little Haley waiting for you.

Jane puts and hand over Lewis', he squeezes it.

JANE
(whispered)
It's almost over.

LEWIS
Yeah...

The driver takes a brief scan then carefully approaches.

TAXI DRIVER
I see you guys a couple?

JANE

Oh no... we just met tonight.

TAXI DRIVER
Oh I see.

LEWIS
No. Not in that way. She's just
helping me get to my house.

TAXI DRIVER
Can't get home by yourself?

LEWIS
Apparently no.

TAXI DRIVER
Well... we're almost there.

LEWIS
Not exactly, we're going to her
place first.

TAXI DRIVER
You goin' up? I don't got all night
to spend on you two.

LEWIS
No. No she'll go up and I'll go
home, if you'll take me.

TAXI DRIVER
Where do you live?

LEWIS
Up in the Hills.

TAXI DRIVER
I'll take you no problem.

LEWIS
Thanks.

TAXI DRIVER
Yeah.
(a beat)
You mind me asking your names?

LEWIS
I'm Lewis.

TAXI DRIVER
What about you, lady?

JANE AND LEWIS
Jane. Just Jane.

TAXI DRIVER
That's nice.

They laugh.

JANE
What about you?

The driver wasn't expecting that.

TAXI DRIVER
I useda have a name, but people
nowadays just call me Killer.

Dismay is summoned in the backseats by those words.

TAXI DRIVER
You don't gotta worry. Ain't
nothing more than a stupid nickname
from college.

He's lying, but that's not important.

Lewis and Jane get a little of relief out of that last sentence but not that much. Without that charismatic grin the man's expression is incredibly still, unmovable, indifferent to his surroundings in a military kind of way.

The driver switches gears and bolts away.

CUT TO:

Seen from an elevated point, as if we were on top of a building, the taxi speeds away uninterrupted. It keeps a straight line and a steady, brisk pace as nobody else is on the streets right now. From our position we see it disappear down a hill and there we stay for a second, taking a breath, changing tires for the last time before the finishing line.

The bright, full moon is candidly bathing into the curly clouds, unbothered as always. A couple of birds fly before her, a stray dog crosses the road upon which she powerfully shines, a homeless man, who seemed to be a pile of garbage, wakes up from his sleep and starts wandering aimless, untill she's up there he feels protected.

The canvas laid before our eyes is scratched by the sound of tires screeching on the tarmac outside of Jane's apartment.

I/E. TAXI - LATER

Lewis looks at Jane right in the eyes, he just now notices how beautiful they are, like sand in a bottle. Precious, valuable, a memoir of something special.

JANE

I guess this is it.

Lewis just nods, he would like to say more, but words melt in his mouth. Jane hugs him, he hugs back, bringing her a little closer.

She tries to pay the driver, but he gently stops her.

TAXI DRIVER

It's on the house ma'am.

Jane and Lewis exchange one last, quick, dense look and then she's out.

LEWIS

Could you wait for her to enter the building please?

TAXI DRIVER

Sure thing.

She's out there, in front of the door, ready to enter, she just can't find her keys. Lewis looks at her through that faded taxi window, he'd like to jump out and tell her that he deeply doesn't want it to be it. He's stuck though, he can't get out, he's too much of a coward, or at least he believes himself to be, therefore he is.

TAXI DRIVER

You're not gonna say anything?

LEWIS

What?

TAXI DRIVER

You just gon' stay there looking at her like that?

LEWIS

What would I even? It doesn't metter. Maybe I should've, but it's okay.

TAXI DRIVER

For sure it won't metter in a few seconds.

She's found her keys and she's put them in, twisted them and is now about to go in.

Lewis feet are seen as he opens the door and hops out of the taxi, transitioning us into...

EXT. HELEN'S HOUSE - DAY

Lewis steps out of Helen's car, she comes out from the driver seat slamming the door. She's holding three roses but she looks furious.

HELEN

I can't fucking believe you would say that.

LEWIS

(as she's going past the small gate)

Oh come on... you know what I meant by that.

She halts in disbelief.

HELEN

Oh do I? Do I fucking know what you fucking meant?

Lewis hints an answer.

HELEN

Don't fucking answer to that. You know something Lew? I love you, I really do, I think you are incredibly smart and caring and affectionate, but sometimes... sometimes it seems like you forget that I'm a person as well... just because I understand what you mean, or don't mean, it doesn't mean you don't hurt me, us, very, very much.

He doesn't know what to say, a rare occasion to be honest. He's not used to be put face to face with his flaws.

She lets the roses fall to the ground.

HELEN

I don't think we should have dinner tonight Lew.

LEWIS

Shouldn't we talk about this, Helen?

HELEN

I don't have anything left to say, I'm sorry.

All around Lewis starts spinning until we find him...

INT. BAR COUNTER - A FEW DAYS LATER

Lewis has an half full pint of beer in front of him, a couple of empties lay around. He's looking straight ahead, into CAMERA.

LEWIS

(as if mid-sentence)
... and still she hasn't called,
Pete. I don't know what to do.

CAMERA moves a little to find PETER sitting on Lewis' right, the same drinks on his side.

PETER

Why did you have to say that?

LEWIS

I didn't mean it in that way!

PETER
That's not the fucking point Lew.
You can't just say...

HARD CUT TO:

INT. HELEN'S CAR - DAY

LEWIS
(exasperated, in a fight)
What's even the point of having a
fucking baby then?

HARD CUT TO:

INT. BAR COUNTER - SAME AS BEFORE

PETER (CONT'D)
... to you four-month pregnant
girlfriend. You just gotta wait
man, she'll come around, but know
that you screwed up. Big time.

Lewis acknowledge Peter's word by taking a big sip from his
pint, then his phone starts ringing as he puts it back on
the counter. He doesn't recognize the number.

LEWIS
(concerned)
Yeah... this is he...

As a female voice explain the metter, despair appears on his
face.

INT. HOSPITAL WAITING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

It is the same waiting room as before. We're at St.Mary's.

Lewis sits alone in a chair, Sonia is sitting behind him.
He's looking at the floor but he's not seeing it. His brain
is traveling at a hundred miles per hour, his heart
following short behind, his legs unable to rest.

Pete comes through the door.

PETER
Hey. I got you some water.

Lewis doesn't even consider his existence. Peter opens
Lewis' hand and puts a paper glass of water in it, Lewis
immediately squeezes so hard it almost explodes in his hand.

PETER
I'm sure it'll be fine.

Suddenly the same doctor as before comes out the other door.

DOCTOR
Mr. Lewis Gibson?

Lewis brusquely jumps out his chair and draws closer to him.

DOCTOR
Mr. Gibson... I have to be very
honest with you.

Lewis tightens his hand.

DOCTOR (CONT'D)
When they brought miss Carsi in,
the situation looked very bad, very
unpromising.

PETER
(in the background)
Oh God...

DOCTOR
Thankfully, we were able to save
miss Carsi's life, she's going to
make it, unfortunately, and I'm
truly sorry to say this Mr. Gibson,
we haven't been able to save your
daughter as well.

LEWIS
(confused)
My dau... my what...
(faced)
I can't... I don't...

Lewis staggers a couple steps back, he almost falls down but
Peter catches him.

Lewis looks up at the ceiling as he does at the sky when...

EXT. JANE'S BUILDING - SAME AS BEFORE

... he exits the taxi in order to says:

LEWIS
Jane wait.

She was already a shoe in.

JANE
Yes?

LEWIS
I don't want it to be it.

JANE
What are you talking about?

LEWIS
You said "I guess this is it", you
guessed wrong. I think I'm really
starting to like you Just Jane.

JANE
You're a really weird guy Lewis
Gibson.

LEWIS
I think we should go out some day.

JANE
I have your number, you just gotta
find a phone.

LEWIS
I will.

They exchange tender looks one last time.

JANE
Goodnight Lewis Gibson.

LEWIS
Goodnight Just Jane.

Now she really goes up to her apartment, Lewis is once again
there, all alone, but now he has a little sense of purpose.

He gets back in the taxi.

TAXI DRIVER
Got her?

LEWIS
I think I just might.

TAXI DRIVER
Good for ya. Where to now?

LEWIS
Home.

The cab sprints away.

The light up in Jane's apartment switches on, she appears at
the window while observing the yellow taxi darting away.

INT. TAXI - MOMENTS LATER

Lewis sits in the middle seat, his legs spread, finally a bit relaxed.

TAXI DRIVER
Long night?

LEWIS
Very much so.

TAXI DRIVER
What happened?

LEWIS
I don't wanna bore you with the details...but let's just say at moments it really felt like somebody didn't want me to get home.

TAXI DRIVER
You can't bore a taxi driver.

LEWIS
I'm afraid this would.

TAXI DRIVER
If you say so.

They hit a red light.

LEWIS
"Killer" you said they call you?

TAXI DRIVER
These days mostly that, yeah.

LEWIS
What's your real name? If I may ask.

The driver points at the license printed on the glove compartment. It's very old and so faded that it is only possible to read "T" next to "First name" and 02/08/1976 next to "Date of issue".

LEWIS
You've been doing this a while.

TAXI DRIVER
Yeah. I used to consider myself god's lonely man, y'know. Sometimes it can get to ya.

LEWIS

The job?

TAXI DRIVER

The loneliness.

The light turns green, Lewis gulps loudly.

TAXI DRIVER (CONT'D)

But y'know, you just gotta find a way to deal with it. The right way, 'cause any way, that just won't do...

and also you can't eliminate the loneliness, loneliness is an unavoidable component of the human condition, there's no escape from it. It's all about reacting, I learnt it the hard way, but I did, sorta... I guess what I'm saying is... acknowledge it, embrace it, but never lean into it too much... 'cause it will swallow you and you won't even notice. I don't know if I'm making any sense.

Lewis is flabbergasted by the cabbie's eloquence.

TAXI DRIVER (CONT'D)

I mean you did good by taking a chance with the girl, that's all.

LEWIS

You think so?

TAXI DRIVER

Nobody has to be alone.

Right in that moment something flashes through Lewis' head.

HE HAS A PHONE IN HIS DESK DRAWER.

LEWIS

STOP THE CAB.

The taxi noisily stops.

LEWIS

I have one last stop to make.

TAXI DRIVER

I'm sorry but I can't be seen driving you around town for free.

LEWIS
I have some cash there.

TAXI DRIVER
Where?

LEWIS
Do you know a paper called "Here,
Today, Weekly"?

The taxi is seen making a sudden left turn.

EXT. COLLEGE BAR - NIGHT

It's closing time and very young, very drunk people are flowing out the fake-wooden door swaying and stumbling. Some come out holding a plastic cup, having taken their drink to go, others come out looking down, saddened by the bursting spoiler of what is coming the following morning.

Among these customers, there's also Helen with her long-time best friend, Carly. They are not really drunk but they have been drinking for sure, they also stand out a little as they are older than the rest of the crowd.

HELEN
(bursting out the door)
Did you see that fucking guy?

CARLY
The one with the blue suit?

HELEN
Him.

CARLY
No, I didn't see him.

HELEN
You bitch.

Helen mocks an attack on her friend, leading them both to laughing lightly while getting to a nearby bench

HELEN
No but seriously I think he might
have been a serial killer.

CARLY
Oh for sure he was.

HELEN
For sure?!

CARLY

For sure! He's the kind of guy to go up to a girl in a bar and be like:

(mocking the VALENTINO
SUIT GUY)

I work in *finance*... y'know.

HELEN

That sounds exactly like him.

CARLY

(again mocking, winking)
y'know...

Helen loud laugh is heard all over the street.

HELEN

(catching her breath)
Oh gosh... I wish I didn't have to go home.

INT. TAXI - SAME TIME

The setting is the same as before, only Lewis seems more excited.

LEWIS

Everyone said I was a fool for jumping on that plan... two phones, same number...

(squeaky voice)

What do you need two phones for?

You are not a coke dealer, are you?

(normal voice)

Who's the fool now eh?

TAXI DRIVER

I really don't know anymore.

At this point Lewis is almost monologuing, the driver is his audience.

LEWIS

This is going to be good, don't you think? I mean... Jane is great, really great... and God knows I need a new start, a new home.

EXT. BENCH - SAME TIME

The two girls sit loose on the bench.

HELEN
What time is it?

CARLY
It's getting kinda late.

HELEN
(sorry)
Seriously?

CARLY
I got work in the morning girl.

HELEN
So do I!

CARLY
You work from home.

HELEN
Still work though!

INT. TAXI - SAME TIME

LEWIS
You think she's already called? No,
why should she? Well, she might
have.

TAXI DRIVER
She might.

LEWIS
Right? Surely she'll call in the
morning. I mean later, it's already
morning in a way.

TAXI DRIVER
It ain't morning 'till the sun's
up.

LEWIS
But she'll call. Or text. Or
whatever. Right? Yeah she will. We
had a good time in a way, I think.
I hadn't felt that way in a long
time, you know?

TAXI DRIVER
Seems like it.

LEWIS
I feel like I'm talking too much.
Am I talking too much?

TAXI DRIVER
 (ignoring the question)
 A couple mo' blocks and we're
 there.

EXT. BENCH - SAME TIME

CARLY
 Come on it's time to go.

Carly pulls herself up, Helen holds on a little longer.

INT. TAXI - SAME TIME

The driver checks on Lewis and radiantly smiles at him.
 Lewis can't help it but to smile back.

LEWIS
 What?

TAXI DRIVER
 It's nice to see a kid not get
 lost.

EXT. BENCH - SAME TIME

Carly helps Helen get up too.

CARLY
 Let's go

HELEN
 I guess.

FROM THIS POINT ON THE CAMERA WALKS NEXT TO HELEN, TAKING IN ONLY HER RIGHT PROFILE. AS SHE WALKS SHE DRAGS THE SHOT ALONG WITH HER, MAKING SPACE IN THE FRAME FOR THE SHOT OF LEWIS, SITTING IN THE BACK OF THE TAXI, TAKEN ONLY FROM HIS LEFT SIDE. CAMERA DOES SO UNTIL THEY ARE IN SPLIT SCREEN.

HELEN
 What time are you starting
 tomorrow?

CARLY (O.S.)
 At eight.

HELEN
 I see.

CARLY (O.S.)
 Don't guilt trip me, please.

LEWIS
(passing the Fat Fairy
Diner on his right)
I think I've already passed by this
street tonight.

TAXI DRIVER (O.S.)
Yes?

LEWIS
(passing the French
restaurant)
Yeah... I think so.

The taxi passes the bar and then, finally, at the same
time, Lewis and Helen see each other.

END OF SPLIT SCREEN

Lewis is left speechless, there are no doubts this time,
it's really Helen. She, as if her soul had left her body,
gets a cold feeling that expands from the stomach to the
rest of her body, her legs sink in the asphalt. It feels
like a mirage.

INT. TAXI

TAXI DRIVER
You seen a ghost?

EXT. STREET - SAME TIME

CARLY
Hel? What happened?

INT. TAXI - SAME TIME

LEWIS
You can leave me here.

TAXI DRIVER
I'm not making anymore stops.

LEWIS
That's okay.

EXT. STREET - SAME TIME

HELEN
Lewis was in that taxi.

CARLY
(astonished)
Lewis Lewis? Your Lewis?

HELEN
That Lewis.

They see the taxi stop a few hundred yards down the road,
right before an intersection.

CARLY
How long has it been?

HELEN
Since I've seen him?

CARLY
Since you've talked to him.

INT. TAXI - SAME TIME

Lewis is ready to go face his demons for the last time, but
first it's time to say goodbye to his last Virgil.

TAXI DRIVER
You sure you wanna be left here?

LEWIS
You've ever had something stuck in
your mind so deep that it follows
in your dreams?

TAXI DRIVER
I've always had trouble getting my
sleep... and even when I did it was
never a quiet one.

LEWIS
So maybe you can understand why I
gotta do this.

TAXI DRIVER
You tryna ease your mind for good?

LEWIS
Something like that, yeah.

Lewis opens the door to the left.

LEWIS
Goodnight....

He struggles to find the name.

TAXI DRIVER
"Killer".

LEWIS
Goodnight "Killer" and thank you.
For real. I don't know if they tell
you enough, but you're a good man.

The grin harmonically appears on the driver's face. He isn't told that as much as he should.

TAXI DRIVER
I'm just a taxi driver.
(a beat)
Have a good one kid.

Lewis gets out and the taxi runs off.

EXT STREET - CONTINUOUS

Now it is time. Lewis and Helen, at last they meet again.

Lewis starts decisively walking towards her, she does the same and Carly follows closely.

They stop a few feet away from each other. It's a true stand-off. One full of contrasting emotions and dense of unspoken words. No one dares to speak first. They just gaze into each other's eyes, happy to meet again, unsure whether it is fate or bad luck that brought them to that street.

Thankfully Carly opts to alleviate that burden from her friend's shoulders.

CARLY
Hi Lewis!

LEWIS
(cordially)
Hi Carly! How are you?

They share a friendly hug and kiss on the cheek while Helen is yet to speak, yet to move, yet to process.

After the hug Lewis goes back to Helen, thereby making Carly realize that there isn't much left for her to do.

CARLY
Well guys... I think I'm gonna go.

LEWIS
(absent-mindedly)
Goodnight Carly.

HELEN
(not even looking at her)
Night Carl.

Carly hangs on one more second, looking first at Helen and then at Lewis, as if to ask "Are you being serious?", but since they are in fact being serious, she effectively leaves.

CARLY
(low voice)
Every time like this with those two.

Helen and Lewis are now alone for the first time in what can only be defined as ages for two people that used to share that strong a bond.

LEWIS
Hello Helen.

HELEN
Lewis.

Their faces stay still for a little more, they are both hoping the other is bluffing with the long face, but neither one of them is having the courage to call it, until...

HELEN
(breaking in to a smile)
It's really nice seeing you.

Lewis drops the act instantly.

They hug, but they hug very differently from the way he and Carly did, there's love in this one.

LEWIS
So... what brings you to this part of town?

HELEN
(pointing behind Lewis)
See that bar?

LEWIS
That lousy college bar?

HELEN
Exactly, but it's quite nice to be fair.

LEWIS
Is it?

HELEN
You've never been there?

LEWIS
No, why?

HELEN
You literally work a couple of
streets away.

A moment of silence descends.

HELEN
(embarrassed)
You still work there right?

LEWIS
Well... actually...

HELEN
Oh my God, I'm so sorry... I had no
idea.

LEWIS
I'm just kidding, I was right on my
way there, but then...

HELEN
But then you saw me.

LEWIS
But then I saw you.

HELEN
What were you doing going back this
time of night?

LEWIS
I forgot my phone... well not
"forgot" but stil. It's been quite
a night.

HELEN
(tenderly)
You look tired.

LEWIS
I am.

This is a long awaited moment for Lewis. He's missed her
with every fiber of his body, with every drop of his blood,
with every inch of his skin, but now he doesn't seem to know
what to say.

LEWIS
Would you like to come with me?

HELEN
To get your phone at your office?

LEWIS
It's not what it seems.

HELEN
I know Lew.

LEWIS
I can call you a cab from there.

HELEN
Are there any cabs tonight?

LEWIS
Aren't there? I got here in one.

HELEN
You don't look like it's been an
easy ride.

LEWIS
As it ever been easy?

Ace.

She jokingly sighs, then passes a hand through her hair.

HELEN
Let's go.

Helen starts walking and passes him. Lewis waits a moment,
taking in what's really happening. What's to gain from this?

HELEN
Changed your mind already?

LEWIS
(ironically)
I'm coming, I'm coming, always with
the attitude eh?

HELEN
(same way)
You're one to talk.

They serenely stroll away, as the bar owner comes out the
fake-wooden door after having turned off the lights. He's
holding a plastic sign in his hands which he places on the
door. It reads "TIME TO GO HOME".

INT. LEWIS' OFFICE - LATER

Lewis opens the door, they enter but it's quite dark inside. They can't see a thing.

HELEN

Has it always been this dark?

LEWIS

It usually is when it's closed.

Lewis sweeps a couple of feet to the left on the fitted carpet, then flips the switch.

The lights flicker a bit before switching on. When they do they generate an incredibly intense white light, it's the brightest we get to see our characters, even more than in the manager's office back at Gerry's. It contrasts with the general tone the night has had up to this point.

The office is pretty much standard. There are a bunch of cubicles in the middle of the bullpen, two personal offices on the left side of the room and a door opposite to the entrance that leads to the conference room and the adjacent annex. Lewis' cubicle is the one closest to said door.

HELEN

That's bright.

LEWIS

Yeah, we're trying to get it changed to something a little more subtle.

HELEN

It hasn't changed a bit.

LEWIS

Improvement and development aren't exactly "Here, Today, Weekly"'s strongest suits.

Helen laughs timidly.

LEWIS

You always loved that name.

HELEN

Always.

They briefly get caught into each other's eyes. It touches Lewis' feelings in a way that he isn't sure he does want to experience, so he breaks it off.

LEWIS
Come on, let's get that phone and
get you home.

HELEN
Sure thing.

They head over to Lewis' cubicle.

INT. LEWIS' CUBICLE - LEWIS' OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

His desk is an absolute mess. There are papers and documents everywhere, post-its latched on to anything that sticks. In this sea of untidiness, a framed photo of the two of them shines like gold in a pot of copper. We don't immediately see what they are doing in the photo.

HELEN
(picking up the photo)
You still have this.

Lewis feels almost embarrassed, he never noticed it had always been on his desk.

LEWIS
Yeah... I never... I never realized
I had never put it away.

HELEN
Remember that night?

Helen turns the picture to Lewis. It shows the two of them at an Halloween party. He's just wearing a name tag that says "Hi! My name is Dave.", while she's in a Selina Mayer costume, she's even got the wig.

LEWIS
Halloween 2015... such a *huge*
fight.

HELEN
If only someone hadn't changed his
mind about being Gary at the last
second.

LEWIS
My idea was way better.

HELEN
As I said back then: there's no
such thing as a Jim and Pam
costume, their all thing is that
they are regular people.

LEWIS
That's why it's funny.

HELEN
The show. The costume made zero sense. You just didn't want to dress up.

LEWIS
Absolutely true.

HELEN
Half the people didn't even get that I was going as Selina.

LEWIS
Not that many people knew about "Veep".

HELEN
They should have, and you know that.

LEWIS
Again, absolutely true.
(a beat)
Remember that girl that asked you if you were going as...

HELEN
Monica Lewinsky.
(mocking the voice)
You look nothing like Julia Louis-Dreyfusss.
(normal voice)
My god I wanted to strangle her, and you, and then her again, and then you both.

LEWIS
That seems like an appropriate reaction.

HELEN
You do remember that it was not just about the costume thing, right?

LEWIS
It wasn't?

HELEN
Are you kidding me?

Lewis makes a Jim-kind of face to her signifying he has no idea what she's talking about.

HELEN

Right before we left for the party.
I was telling you about my mother
coming to town the following week.
Remember?

LEWIS

Vaguely.

HELEN

I told you she was having trouble
finding an hotel she could afford
and my roommate didn't want her to
stay with us...

LEWIS

Right.

HELEN

Remember what you said to me?

LEWIS

(looking down, realizing)
Has she looked at Airbnb?

HELEN

There you go.

LEWIS

You could have just asked if she
could stay with me. I would have
said yes!

HELEN

I was building up to it.

LEWIS

It was a joke.

HELEN

Of course it was.

LEWIS

Oh my God. Can we not have the
remake of a fight from seven years
ago right now?

HELEN

Right. Sorry.

LEWIS
I'm sorry too.

HELEN
Let's get the phone come on. It's
getting kinda late.

Lewis pops the top drawer of his desk. A screenplay slides out, it is titled "The Prince Of Nothing". He quickly pushes the drawer back.

HELEN
Was that what I think it was?

LEWIS
Depends on what you're thinking.

HELEN
You know what I'm thinking.

LEWIS
I lost that power a long time ago.

HELEN
It was the "Prince", wasn't it?

LEWIS
(disappointed)
Yes it was.

HELEN
Why are you saying it like that?
You *finally* finished it.

LEWIS
Well... yeah but...

HELEN
But what?

LEWIS
I don't know. It lived in my mind
for so long that now that it's
actually on paper... it almost
feels like I've taken it out of its
habitat. You know?

HELEN
I see you haven't changed either.

LEWIS
What do you mean?

HELEN

You've always, always been this way about your writing. So proud of it, so confident in its quality, yet so scared of showing it to the world. To anybody for that matter. It took you six months just to tell me you liked writing. How long did it take me to tell you my biggest dream in the world?

LEWIS

To be able to live life based on love and not on money?

HELEN

Yeah.

LEWIS

I think you told me on our second date. I remember 'cause I took you to that Nigerian restaurant Pete had told me about.

She's surprised he remembers it so vividly.

HELEN

I still have Nigerian every week.

LEWIS

Me too.

HELEN

We're going off topic.

LEWIS

Right.

HELEN

What I'm trying to say is that you can't just hide in yourself such a big part of who you are, of who you want to be. Some people we'll appreciate it, other won't. Fuck those who won't, at least you'll have shown who you are, for real. Look I'm not saying you gotta be as straightforward as I was, just don't suffocate that wonderful side of you.

LEWIS

Wonderful?

HELEN

You know how much I love your writing.

LEWIS

You wanna read a piece of it?

HELEN

Has somebody else read it?

LEWIS

You'd be the first, as you've always been.

HELEN

When did you finish it?

LEWIS

A couple of days ago. Picked it up from the print shop this morning.

Lewis takes the screenplay out of the drawer and tosses it to Helen.

She scrolls through it with her thumb while holding it close to her nose.

HELEN

It's so crisp, it feels like freshly baked bread.

LEWIS

You still rate books based on which kind of baked good they remind you of?

HELEN

(snarky)

Sometimes I do.

(a beat, then solemnly)

"The Prince Of Nothing" written by Lewis Gibson.

(normal)

So far so good.

LEWIS

You're gonna read it out loud?

HELEN

You know I am.

LEWIS

I really would prefer if you didn't.

HELEN

Oh I know you would.

She proceeds to turn the first page.

HELEN (CONT'D)

"The sound of silence echoes through the chamber. No one speaks because no one dares to utter the fatal question. Had the Prince Of Nothing become the King Of All?"

She lifts her eyes up from the screenplay and points them to Lewis.

HELEN (CONT'D)

That's a good fucking opening.

LEWIS

Right?

Helen would continue reading but a buzz is heard inside the bottom drawer.

HELEN

I think you got a text or something.

LEWIS

I don't think so.

HELEN

Well your drawer went like...

She imitates the buzzing noise.

Lewis knows that it's probably Jane checking on him, but the only thing he wants right now is for Helen to keep reading his words out loud.

LEWIS

It's probably just some junk mail. You know? They send you e-mails at random hours asking you to switch to the premium service or some shit like that.

HELEN

I think it's just a text Lewis.

LEWIS

We'll check later.

HELEN

Why are you being weird?

LEWIS

Weird? How am I being weird?

HELEN

'cause you're lying to me. You know it was a text. Why do you still feel like you gotta hide shit from me?

LEWIS

I'm not hiding anything Helen.

HELEN

Then open the drawer.

LEWIS

Can't you read a couple more pages and then we'll go?

HELEN

Lewis.

Lewis shakes his head before unwillingly picking up the phone.

HELEN

So?

LEWIS

It was a text.

HELEN

From a girl.

LEWIS

What? No. It was Pete.

HELEN

No it wasn't.

LEWIS

Yes it was.

HELEN

Let me see for myself then.

LEWIS

It wasn't Pete.

HELEN

I know.

(MORE)

HELEN (CONT'D)

(a beat)

Did you think I was gonna storm out
if you told me you're seeing
someone? I'm seeing someone too,
you know? I am happy for you.

Lewis is not happy. Not because she's seeing someone, he knew that, but because once again she proved herself to have this ability to read right through him. Through his games, through his lies, through his supposedly clever reasonings. It is what he had always loved and also hated about her: on the one hand she would challenge him from an intellectual standpoint, on the other she would make him feel naive when she inevitably bested him.

This sensation he's tasting, she can perceive it from a mile away.

HELEN

What's her name?

LEWIS

Jane.

HELEN

How long have you known each other?

LEWIS

We met tonight. It's a wired story.

HELEN

Is that the first text she's ever
sent you?

LEWIS

Yes.

HELEN

Then why aren't you answering?

LEWIS

You know why.

HELEN

No I don't.

LEWIS

Are you being serious?

HELEN

What? What is the reason you can't
answer to this girl?

LEWIS
Are you really going to make me say
it?

HELEN
Say what?

LEWIS
I can't answer to the beautiful,
amazing Jane...

He takes a deep breath.

LEWIS (CONT'D)
I can't answer to the beautiful,
amazing Jane because the beautiful,
amazing Jane is not you. Nobody is,
not even closely. Also you're
here... and I can't bring myself to
care about anything outside this
cubicle if you're here.

HELEN
Then maybe I should leave...

LEWIS
That's not what I meant. It's not a
physical *here*. Fuck. I just... I
just miss you so much Helen.

HELEN
You gotta let me go Lew.

LEWIS
I have... tried. I really have. But
no matter what, fate always seems
to be bringing myself back to you.
Like tonight... tonight I was all
over town, I even was at St. Mary's
at some point. All that just for
ending up right where I started. I
really really wish I could just let
you go Helen, but I can't.

HELEN
Do you want to let me go?

LEWIS
(tears in his eyes)
Yes. More than anything.

HELEN
Then it's over Lew.

LEWIS

If it's over, why are you here?

HELEN

Am I?

After those words Helen dissipates like a soft cloud blown away by the morning breeze.

CAMERA SPINS TO FIND LEWIS IN HIS CHAIR LOOKING UP, CATATONIC WHILE SOME PEOPLE ARE STILL IN THE OFFICE.

INT. LEWIS' OFFICE - NIGHT

The few people left in the building are starting to leave as well. The majority of the cubicles are already empty, but both of the personal offices have the lights switched on, although the blinds are shut.

Lewis is still sat down. He doesn't have a phone in his hands anymore and his jacket is resting on the back of the chair. A TAXI DRIVER poster is stuck to the wall behind him.

Finally he abandons the amniotic state he was in and decides to leave. He stands up and puts his jacket on then proceeds to give a semblance of order to his desk.

As he exits the cubicle the picture of Jane and him falls on its face.

Before leaving the office he goes to the annex.

In order to reach it, you have to pass a small corridor adjacent to the conference room. In that conference room two women are discussing their plans for the evening, Lewis overhears one of them saying the words "COLLEGE BAR", before opening the door to the annex.

INT. ANNEX - LEWIS' OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

The annex is basically a small bullpen with just four cubicles, three of them are empty, the top right one is lit by candles. Lewis enters it.

At the four corners of the desk, four red circular candles burn, in the middle a small dark plaque reads "May she always guide us". Perpendicular to the plaque, on the wall, a photo of a woman that looks just like ARIADNE is hung. The dates 1954 and 2004 are engraved in the gold frame.

LEWIS

See you tomorrow.

INT. LEWIS' OFFICE - MOMENTS LATER

Lewis comes back from the annex.

Next stop is the first of the personal offices. He checks the blinds before knocking. He can't quite see who's inside, but someone definitely is.

He knocks again and this time a voice allows him in.

INT. PERSONAL OFFICE 1 - LEWIS' OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

LEWIS

Mr. Ryan I was just about to...

CLEANING MAN

I'm afraid Mr. Ryan has left some time ago.

The cleaning man who greeted Lewis instead of Mr. Ryan looks exactly like FORD, from the bus, just a lot less dirty.

LEWIS

Oh I see... have a goodnight then.

CLEANING MAN

Yeah, you too.

The man resumes cleaning the shelves and Lewis clears out of the room.

INT. LEWIS' OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Now on to the second one and then he'll be able to get out. He's feeling cramped, we can see it on his face, he's not comfortable.

As he's strolling to the office of his other boss a colleague bumps in to him.

COLLEAGUE

(half-heartedly)

Sorry John.

LEWIS

I'm not John.

But the colleague has parted himself already and Lewis couldn't care less about whether that guy knows his name or not.

Again he peeks inside the office to makes sure that this time the person he's looking for is actually there. She is. He knocks.

MS. LAUDERDALE

Come in.

Lewis enters.

INT. PERSONAL OFFICE 2 - LEWIS' OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Lewis' boss, Ms. Lauderdale, is sitting behind her desk typing on her computer. She stops as soon as Lewis steps foot in the room.

LEWIS

Ms. Lauderdale.

MS. LAUDERDALE

Are you leaving Lewis?

LEWIS

Yeah, I think so.

MS. LAUDERDALE

You finished that report on the fish market?

LEWIS

(annoyed)

Yeah.

MS. LAUDERDALE

Don't pout. It's not the best job in the world but surely it's not the worst.

LEWIS

You're right sorry.

MS. LAUDERDALE

It's okay.

(a beat)

By the way... did you manage to catch American Psycho last night?

LEWIS

I actually did.

MS. LAUDERDALE

I can't believe you had never seen it before... so what'd you think?

LEWIS

Amazingg.

MS. LAUDERDALE

Right?

LEWIS

Yeah... so if you don't need anything else I'm gonna go.

MS. LAUDERDALE

Sure. Go get some sleep. You look like shit, you know that right?

LEWIS

Unfortunately I do.

She smirks.

MS. LAUDERDALE

You're a good kid Lewis Gibson.

LEWIS

Thank you Ms. Lauderdale.
Goodnight.

MS. LAUDERDALE

Goodnight...and close the door on your way out, please.

Lewis opts out and Ms. Lauderdale immediately goes back to typing.

INT. LEWIS' OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

It's really time to go.

Lewis slowly walks up to the door, he drags himself through the last feet of the bullpen.

When he is at the door, he hesitates for a brief eternal second. He scans the whole room, all the busy people, working on some piece or collecting their things. The whole odyssey he has been through flashes all together before his eyes. He's ready to go home now.

INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Lewis closes the office door behind him then heads toward the elevator.

He presses the button but it's occupied. He checks the time and sees that it's 9.10. Finally the elevator lands on his floor.

The doors open in front of him and a couple is in there. They look like JANE and MICHAEL MUZZETTI, Lewis offers them a smile which conveys uneasiness. He doesn't smile back and exits while taking his girlfriend's hand.

She follows right back but does smile back, looking him right in the eyes. It is a warm smile, Lewis appreciate it deeply.

Once they have cleared the hallway, he goes in to the elevator and presses 0.

CAMERA DOESN'T FOLLOW LEWIS IN THE ELEVATOR, IT STAYS ON LEWIS AS THE DOORS CLOSE ON HIS TIRED FACE.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

The street is almost empty. There is a woman waiting for the bus at the stop. A couple of guys stand at the corner smoking something, piles of smoke blow from their mouths as they breath through the cold evening.

The hall of the building in the middle of the street lights up. A black car passes in front of it and picks up the woman from the nearby bus stop.

Lewis walks down the stairs in the building.

He exits from the glass doors, then suddenly stops, as if struck by a lightning thought.

WALKER passes by behind him, but Lewis fails to notice him.

He brings his eyes back to the hall but the lights switch off. He shrugs then looks around for a moment. It seems like he's looking for something or someone, but doesn't find anything.

Eventually Lewis decides to walk to the bus stop, as he does, our journey comes to an end. We watch him walk away from behind.

The HOMELESS MAN from the opening staggers next to us holding his beer bottle.

Somber music starts playing.

FADE OUT.

THE END

